

The Noun *ʾiš* in Ancient Hebrew: A Marker of Essential Participation

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Abstract

Taking a functional, cognitive, and communication-oriented approach, this paper posits that in ancient Hebrew, the noun *ʾiš* often played a distinctive role: to signal to an audience that its referent is essential for grasping the depicted situation. In such cases, this noun's meaning resides mainly on the level of the discourse between the speaker and the audience, rather than on the semantic level. Three types of biblical evidence are presented in support of this idea: *ʾiš*-headed appositions, relative clauses that either serve in lieu of a substantive or modify *ʾiš*, and clauses that introduce an unquantified subset of a known group. The tests involve comparing cases where *ʾiš* is present in a referring expression versus similar cases where it is absent. The study found that all of the studied cases with *ʾiš* were sketching a new or modified situation, in which this noun's referent was profiled as a key participant. In contrast, all cases without *ʾiš* treated the referent of interest as a given element. The hypothesis accounts for 129 biblical instances of *ʾiš* that scholars had deemed pointless or puzzling. Hence it yields a Hebrew Bible text that is more coherent and informative.

Keywords: Biblical Hebrew; Old Testament; pragmatics; functional linguistics; cognitive linguistics; *ʾiš*

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Introduction: The Puzzle of איש-headed Appositions¹

Consider a strong assertion by the late biblical scholar Frank Andersen (1994, 106; emphasis in original): “*Everything in a text does something.*” If so, in the Hebrew Bible, the presence of the noun איש must somehow be meaningful.² Yet according to conventional wisdom, איש is frequently meaningless.

Of the “meaningless” cases, the exemplary class is apposition. Prototypically, apposition is the juxtaposition of two noun phrases that point toward the same referent.³ Each of those two referring expressions offers useful information about their referent. Yet in the 40 cases where איש is the head term in an apposition,⁴ its meaning contribution has been regularly discounted by expert translations (Table 1) and by dictionaries (Table 2). For example, the term איש כהן is treated just like כהן (a priest) by itself.

Meanwhile, grammarians’ treatments of איש as the head term include the following claims.

- איש functions as the broadest possible term for people—a generic noun of class (Waltke and O’Connor 1990, 230, 252).
- Such appositions collocate the genus and species labels (Joüon 2006, 449; Arnold and Choi 2018, 29–31).
- In such appositions, the second member specifies the status of the first member (Van der Merwe, Naudé, and Kroeze 2017, 263).

All of these explanations imply that, in effect, איש contributes no meaning beyond what the modifier noun would provide on its own. The same is true of analyses that

Table 1: Renderings of איש-headed appositions in recent English translations

Location	Referring Expression	Typical Rendering
Exod 2:7	אִשָּׁה מִיִּנְקָה	a nurse (NJPS, NRSV, ESV)
Lev 21:9	אִישׁ כֹּהֵן	a priest (NJPS, NRSV, Alter)
Judg 6:8	אִישׁ נָבִיא	a prophet (NJPS, NRSV, ESV)
2 Sam 1:13	אִישׁ גֵּר	a sojourner (ESV, Alter)
1 Kgs 17:9	אִשָּׁה אֶלְמָנָה	a widow (NJPS, NRSV, ESV)

- 1 Adapted from a paper presented to the Linguistics and Biblical Hebrew seminar, Society of Biblical Literature annual meeting, 9 December 2020. This paper’s supplemental Tables 6–10 and Excursuses 1–5 are available at purl.org/scholar/marker-2021. Published translations are quoted for the reader’s convenience; they do not necessarily reflect my own construals.
- 2 Hebraists commonly gloss the masculine singular form איש as ‘man’ or ‘person’. However, any such gloss clearly fails for the cases treated herein, which is why a gloss is not provided in the body of this paper.
- 3 On apposition, see further Holmstedt and Jones 2017.
- 4 See Tables 6 and 7B (above, n. 1).

Table 2: Treatment of **אִישׁ**-headed appositions in typical biblical dictionaries

Dictionary	Language	Gist of the Treatment
Simonis and Eichhorn 1793	German	No translatable meaning
Gesenius (1829) 1835	German	No translatable meaning
Koehler and Baumgartner (1967) 1995	German	No translatable meaning
Koehler and Baumgartner (1967) 2001	English	No translatable meaning
Schökel 1993	Spanish	Equivalent to indefinite article, ⁵ or null

have taken a historical approach, concluding that **אִישׁ**-headed appositions are a vestigial scribal practice—transferred from occasional use of a determinative marker in Akkadian (Staples 1941; Yoder 2015).⁶

In addition to contradicting Andersen’s principle that a literary work does not waste words, the aforementioned views are at odds with psycholinguistic findings on how apposition is processed in the mind. Researchers have concluded that in the conceptual-combination effort that is involved in the mental processing of noun-noun phrases, the contribution of the head noun is significant (Gagné and Spalding 2013). Thus, the biblical text’s audience will automatically strive to wrest meaning from **אִישׁ** as the head noun.

Tellingly, no explanation has yet accounted for why **אִישׁ** appears *only occasionally* with its accompanying substantive, e.g., כֹּהֵן in Lev 21:9,

וּבֵת אִישׁ כֹּהֵן כִּי תִחַל לְזָנוֹת

When the daughter of a priest defiles herself through harlotry (NJPS)

rather than everywhere that such substantives are used, e.g., Lev 22:12:

וּבֵת-כֹּהֵן כִּי תִהְיֶה לְאִישׁ זָר

If a priest’s daughter marries a layman (NJPS)

Hypothesis of Meaningfulness

A new hypothesis now explains these and other enigmatic usages of **אִישׁ**. The claim is that this noun has a special discourse function: it helps to manage the communication

5 While an indefinite article is meaningful, that meaning would be evident even without the use of **אִישׁ** in the constructions in question. Thus Schökel’s statement does not account for the noun’s presence.

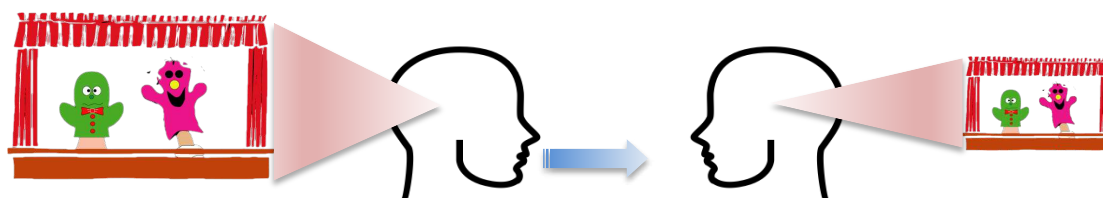
6 On prior scholarship regarding **אִישׁ**-headed appositions, see [Excursus 1](#) (above, n. 1). One of the few scholars to attribute meaning to our noun as the head term in an apposition is Naomi Steinberg (2003). She correlated the different terminology for widows with the varying depictions of their economic conditions. She concluded that the term **אַלְמָנָה** alone and the term **אִשָּׁה אַלְמָנָה** refer to distinct social categories. Her analysis treats the appositional term as denoting a special type of widow: an “inherited widow, with son.”

between a speaker and an audience.⁷ In many cases, the noun *שֵׂרָא* signals to an audience that its referent is essential for grasping the depicted situation. At issue, then, is the text's *pragmatics*: how words are used to communicate beyond their surface meaning. As we shall see, this hypothesis accounts not only for this noun's presence but also for its absence. Additionally, it sheds light upon 175 varied usages of *שֵׂרָא* that otherwise seem superfluous.

Theory: Situations and Participants

Cognitive psychologists assert that human cognition is largely devoted to keeping track of elements within situations.⁸ It is self-evident that among the situational elements that most consistently receive our mental attention are human participants. This abiding interest is expressed in our communication. As the late linguist Knud Lambrecht observed (1994, 46), "Informing a hearer of something ... necessarily involves not only participants but also something to participate in [i.e., a situation]."

Whenever a speaker depicts some situation, their audience forms a mental representation of it. Scholars call that representation a "discourse model" or "situation model."⁹ It is populated by participants whom the audience must keep track of. The figure below illustrates this idea.



In successful communication, the speaker's mental representation of a depicted situation and its participants (*left*) is reproduced in the audience's own representation (*right*).

Communication is thus a matter of synchronisation between speaker and audience. Speakers are expected to help their audience to promptly grasp what is being described. They do so by giving signals that facilitate the synchrony during communication.

⁷ This paper uses the term *speaker* to include also a writer, and *audience* to include also a reader. The audience is styled as a singular collective entity ("it").

⁸ According to Lawrence Barsalou and colleagues (2018, especially 2, 9), situations are precisely what the human brain primarily represents and processes. They call this "the brain's most basic function." That is, the brain situates (perceived or conceived) items within their context; and it attends to the relations among those items. Situations and the relatedness of their elements lie at the heart of cognition.

⁹ Webber 1978, 27–29; Lambrecht 1994; Kintsch 1998; van Berkum et al. 2007; Aitchison 2012, 89.

Taking a functional perspective, the linguist Zygmunt Frajzyngier (2011) has discussed how languages variously encode distinctions regarding participant reference. He notes that each language has its own system for making reference. For the purpose of managing communication with an audience, a speaker must harness its language's common, everyday signals. As Frajzyngier explains,¹⁰

a large variety of [referential] functions are coded by the same lexical sources....
The wide variety of functions coded in the domain of reference is made possible
by combining these lexical sources with ... the absence of any overt coding.
(2011, 10)

In other words, reference systems can convey meaning via the presence-or-absence of a “lexical source.” For this task, nouns are well suited. By their very nature, they operate partly on the discourse level. They form the heads of referring expressions—and the speaker's act of making reference is a discourse function.¹¹

Some languages appear to have developed a special noun that signals which participants are essential to grasping the depicted situation.¹² When that noun is invoked, it overtly codes this desired signal.¹³ Is ancient Hebrew (the language of the Hebrew Bible) among such languages?

Terminology and Methodology

- In this paper, “essential” participants are those whose involvement defines the speaker's depicted situation. That is, in order to grasp that situation, the audience must recognise this participant's presence.
- The present study sets aside the question of what **אִישׁ** conveys about its referent's social gender, in order to ask what else is being communicated.¹⁴ It assumes that the biblical text provides evidence of the ancient language that is accurate enough for this purpose.¹⁵

10 See also Frajzyngier and Shay 2003, 247–82; Frajzyngier and Jirsa 2006.

11 A referring expression prompts the audience to predict that the speaker wants to predicate something about its referent (Ramscar et al. 2010). As T. Givón explains, “Reference—denotation—is ... a mapping from linguistic expressions to individuals established verbally in the Universe of Discourse” (2018, 244).

12 On such a noun in English and in French, see Stein 2020.

13 Saying that the special noun in question *overtly codes* a signal is a more precise functional description than calling it a *marked* expression, as my original paper did (cf. Haspelmath 2006, 29–30).

14 The Bible's composers used the masculine form **אִישׁ** mostly in order to communicate something else about its referent besides gender (Grant 1977; Stein 2008; Stein 2020, 18–19, 142–46, 175n29, 223–24). In the Bible, this term is still quite far from being fully lexically gendered (Stein 2019).

15 A relatively large amount of usage data is extant. Including the feminine form **אִשָּׁה** and plural forms, **אִישׁ** is the second most frequently occurring common noun in the Hebrew Bible—appearing nearly three thousand times. Unless otherwise noted, I restrict myself to instances where the ancient textual witnesses seem to agree on the reading. In practice, I will quote from the Masoretic Text.

- The proper criteria for evaluating whether the hypothesis is valid include: Is **אִשָּׁה** as a label highly correlated with participants who are essential? Conversely, is it inversely correlated with those who are not essential? Furthermore, I must show that any observed usage patterns are features of the language (rather than someone's personal style, or a local lectal variant, or a scribal gloss). This requirement adds two conditions: (1) The usage patterns must be *widely distributed* across the biblical corpus. As a heuristic, I count the number of biblical books in which a given trait appears.¹⁶ (2) The usage patterns in question must be employed by *diverse speakers*. For this purpose, any distinct voice in the Bible counts as one such speaker.¹⁷
- As we shall see, my hypothesis meets the above criteria, as tested for three distinct and well-attested usage patterns for this noun.

Test #1: **אִשָּׁה**-headed Appositions

Near the start of the exodus narrative, after Pharaoh's unnamed daughter finds a baby at the Nile's edge, the child's sister hazards a question (Exod 2:7):

הַאֵלֶּיךָ וְקִרְאֵתִי לָךְ אִשָּׁה מִיִּנְקָת מִן הָעִבְרִיִּית

“Shall I go and call a nursing woman from the Hebrews for you...?” (SB)

“Shall I go and get you a nurse from the Hebrew women...?” (NRSV)

Elsewhere, the noun **מִיִּנְקָת** (wetnurse) serves as a substantive on its own. So why does this girl bother to label her intended referent via apposition, as **אִשָּׁה מִיִּנְקָת**? I propose that she employs **אִשָּׁה** to signal to her audience (the princess) that a hypothetical participant is being introduced whose presence is central to this new proposal, which would dramatically alter the situation. The speaker thus prompts Pharaoh's daughter to situate this new participant within her own situation model.

Although the noun phrase **אִשָּׁה מִיִּנְקָת** occurs only once in the Bible, my explanation for its usage can be tested, via another personal noun, **זִנָּה** (prostitute). That word appears by itself as a label in 21 instances, while the more prolix appositional phrase **אִשָּׁה זִנָּה** is used as a referring expression in 9 instances. This gives us a sizeable data set for comparison.

16 In this study, I have adopted the classic rabbinic enumeration of 24 biblical books: Samuel, Kings, Ezra-Nehemiah, and Chronicles each count as one book, as does the Twelve Minor Prophets. While this approach does not reliably reflect a uniform compositional origin, it does respect each book's subsequent history of development and preservation.

17 Crucially, those distinct voices include the reported speech of particular narrative characters. The text's audience would predictably interpret their speech according to its own conventional parlance—while expecting the speaker's audience within the story to do the same (cf. Stein 2020, 105).

The distribution of this data is wide: both kinds of expression are employed in narration, in reported speech, in legislation, and in prophetic pronouncements; and both kinds appear in each of four disparate biblical books (Table 3). All of those books are internally coherent enough that, taken together, they imply that זִנָּה and אִשָּׁה זִנָּה were alternative expressions employed by the same speakers, who would choose between them as a matter of convention. Consequently, it is valid to ascribe a differential linguistic meaning to these two expressions.

Of the instances of standalone זִנָּה, none impacts the depicted situation itself; rather, they involve ancillary allusions to a stereotype.¹⁸ As for the instances of אִשָּׁה זִנָּה, all of them refer—as predicted—to a participant whose involvement defines the de-

Table 3: Reference to prostitutes, at times via apposition: comparison and distribution

Book	Locale	Coding	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS (Torah/Prophets); Fox (Proverbs)
1 Kgs	22:38	Zero	וַיִּשְׁטֹף אֶת־הָרֶכֶב עַל בְּרֶכֶת שְׁמָרוֹן ... וְהַזְנוֹת רַחֲצוּ ¹⁹	and they flushed out the chariot at the pool of Samaria ... and the whores bathed [in it]
1 Kgs	3:16	Overt	אִזְ תָּבֹאנָה שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים זָנוֹת אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ	Later two prostitutes came to the king
Jer	5:7	Zero	וַיֵּנָאֲפוּ וּבֵית זִזְנָה יִתְגַּדְּדוּ:	And [they] went trooping to the harlot's house.
Jer	3:3	Overt	וַיִּמְצָח אִשָּׁה זִזְנָה הִיא לָךְ	You had the brazenness [lit. forehead] of a street woman
Ezek	16:31	Zero	וְלֹא־הֵייתְּ בַּזִּזְנָה לְקַלֵּס אֶתְנָן	Yet you were not like a prostitute, for you spurned fees
Ezek	23:44	Overt	וַיָּבֹאוּ אֵלֶיהָ כְּבֹא אֶל־אִשָּׁה זִזְנָה	And they would go to her as one goes to a prostitute
Prov	7:10	Zero	וְהִנֵּה אִשָּׁה לְקָרְאָתוֹ שֵׁית זִזְנָה וּנְצָרֶת לֵב:	And now: a woman comes toward him, / in harlot's garb, her intent hidden.
Prov	6:26	Overt	כִּי בַעַד־אִשָּׁה זִזְנָה עַד־כֶּכֶר לֶחֶם וְאִשָּׁת אִישׁ נִפֶּשׁ יִקְרָה תְּצֹוד:	For a whore costs but a loaf of bread, / but a married woman hunts for a precious life.

18 All but one of the 21 instances make a nonspecific reference to a discourse-inconsequential type. The remaining instance (1 Kgs 22:38) refers to a specific yet stereotypical figure in the narrative background.

19 So also Septuagint. Although the Targum and Syriac read differently, they yield a less coherent text.

picted situation.²⁰ In one telling example, Samson goes to Gaza and has sex with a prostitute (Judg 16:1–3). The first verse of this episode relates:

וַיֵּרָא־שָׁם אִשָּׁה זֹנָה וַיָּבֹא אֵלֶיהָ:

there he met a whore and slept with her. (NJPS)

Here the prostitute in question is depicted wholly passively: both of her referring expressions appear in verbal complements; she is cast as a semantic patient; no actions or words are attributed to her; and she plays no further role in the story. Nonetheless, her involvement defines the initial situation. It simply would not exist without her presence.²¹

Armed with this evidence, we have grounds to claim that Moses's sister (Miriam) was indeed pointing to an essential participant by employing אִשָּׁה in her question (Exod 2:7). This construal yields a more informative text. Likewise, we can now revisit Lev 21:9 (repeated below) and explain אִישׁ there as marking an essential participant.

וּבִת־אִישׁ כֹּהֵן כִּי תִחַל לְזָנוֹת

When the daughter of a priest defiles herself through harlotry... (NJPS)

The next clause, אֶת־אָבִיהָ הִיא מְחַלֶּלֶת (it is her father whom she defiles; NJPS), confirms the situation-defining nature of this referent. Within the depicted situation, the father is cast as the injured party; he is then required to initiate a prosecution. Thus his involvement is constitutive. In contrast, the wording in the ostensibly similar passage (22:12, repeated below) takes the father-priest as a given. He is merely a point of departure in depicting that situation. This accounts for why כֹּהֵן is not modified by אִישׁ:

וּבִת־כֹּהֵן כִּי תִהְיֶה לְאִישׁ זָר

If a priest's daughter marries a layman... (NJPS)

In short, whenever אִשָּׁה or אִישׁ heads an apposition, it signals that its referent is a situation-defining participant. Such a referent is cognitively essential.

Test #2: אִישׁ-headed Referring Expressions with a Relative Clause

To what extent does אִישׁ or אִשָּׁה function as a marker of essential participation? What about cases where this noun is juxtaposed with another type of substantive (not a noun), as long as those two terms are used together to point to someone, or to make a point about someone? To explore the function's reach, let us consider a second con-

20 For all 30 cases, see [Table 7](#) (above, n. 1).

21 For analysis of the other instances of אִשָּׁה-headed apposition with זֹנָה, see [Excursus 2](#) (above, n. 1).

struction, as illustrated by the following near-minimal pair. While Joseph is serving as the vizier of Egypt, his steward is introduced into the discourse (Gen 43:16):²²

וַיֹּאמֶר לְאִשְׁרֵי עַל־בֵּיתוֹ

he said to the steward of his house (NRSV)

Three verses later, the same individual is referred to again, but with the addition of our noun (v. 19):

וַיָּגֶשׁוּ אֶל־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר עַל־בֵּית יוֹסֵף

So they went up to the steward of Joseph's house (NRSV)

What accounts for the absence, and then the presence, of *איש* when referring to him? One explanation is that when the steward was introduced, his presence on the scene was treated as a given: everyone knows that a steward is a necessary part of the vizier's household staff. (For this reason, the referring expression's deixis is definite.) In contrast, in the latter instance, the narration frames a new situation that is defined in relation to the steward; he serves as a physical and conceptual point of reference for the action, as the visiting delegation approaches him.

Does that explanation work elsewhere? The Bible includes 45 fairly similar cases—wherein a referring expression appears within a verbal complement, in order to refer to a human being; and in that referring expression, a relative clause is headed by the relative complementiser *אשר*, which either serves in lieu of a substantive or modifies the noun *איש*. These cases are distributed widely: both formulations appear in each of six diverse biblical books and are articulated by varied voices (Table 4). I conclude that these variants form a meaningful pair of alternative expressions. Comparing the 29 cases without *איש* to the 16 cases with it, I find that in all cases without *איש*, the referent of interest is treated as a given element; in contrast, all of the cases with *איש* profile its referent as a key participant in the depicted situation.²³

This finding for relative clauses suggests that when an *איש*-headed expression contains any kind of additional substantive—whether it be a gentilic, an adjective, or a participle—the same meaning would be expected. Namely, the head noun will function to prompt the audience's situation model to treat this referent as essential.²⁴

22 According to the syntactic analysis of Robert Holmstedt (as reflected in the syntax module of Accordance Bible Software), the referring expression here is gapped—that is, it is absent yet implied by the relative clause. For convenience, I treat the relative clause as if it were the referring expression that it invokes.

23 For the full set of 45 cases, see Table 8 (above, n. 1); for discussion of additional exemplars, see Excursus 3 (above, n. 1).

24 For a list of 88 additional referring expressions in which *איש* is semantically superfluous and its modifier is either a gentilic, an adjective, or a participle, see Table 10 (above, n. 1). For case studies involving an adjective (*חכמה אשה* 'woman who is wise' in 2 Sam 14:2; 20:6) and two participles (Prov 22:7; Ezek 45:20), see Excursus 4 (above, n. 1).

Table 4: *אִישׁ*-headed expressions with a relative clause: comparison and distribution

Book	Locale	Coding	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	RJPS (projected)
Gen	43:16	Zero	וַיֹּאמֶר לְאִשְׁרֵי עַל-בֵּיתוֹ	he said to his <u>house steward</u>
Gen	43:19	Overt	וַיֵּגֶשׁוּ אֶל-הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר עַל-בֵּית יוֹסֵף	So they went up to <u>the man in charge</u> of Joseph's house
Lev	27:24	Zero	יָשׁוּב הַשְּׂדֵה לְאִשְׁרֵי קָנָהוּ מֵאִתּוֹ	the land shall revert to <u>the one from</u> whom it was bought
Lev	25:27	Overt	וְהָשִׁיב אֶת-הָעֶדְף לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר מָכַר-לוֹ	the difference shall be refunded to <u>the party to whom</u> it was sold
Num	5:7	Zero	וְנָתַן לְאִשְׁרֵי אִשִּׁם לוֹ	giving it to <u>the one who was</u> wronged
Num	9:13	Overt	וְהָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר-הוּא טָהוֹר וּבִדְרֹךְ לֹא-הָיָה וְחִדֵּל לַעֲשׂוֹת הַפֶּסַח	But if <u>any such party</u> who is pure and not on a journey refrains from offering the passover sacrifice
1 Sam	30:26–27	Zero	וַיִּשְׁלַח מֵהַשָּׁלָל לְזִקְנֵי יְהוּדָה ... לְאִשְׁרֵי בֵּית-אֵל	he sent some of the spoil to the elders of Judah ... [to <u>those</u>] in <u>Bethel</u>
1 Sam	17:27	Overt	כֹּה יַעֲשֶׂה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יָכֵנוּ	what would be done for <u>the one who</u> killed him
2 Kgs	10:22	Zero	וַיֹּאמֶר לְאִשְׁרֵי עַל-הַמִּלְחָמָה	He said to the <u>wardrobe manager</u>
2 Kgs	22:15	Overt	אָמְרוּ לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר-שָׁלַח אֶתְכֶם אֵלַי	"Say to <u>the one who</u> sent you to me"
Mal	3:18	Zero	וּרְאִיתֶם ... בֵּין עֶבֶד אֱלֹהִים לְאִשְׁרֵי לֹא עֲבָדוּ	you shall ... see the difference ... between one who has served God and <u>one who has not</u>
Mal	2:12	Overt	יָכַרְתָּ יְהוָה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשֶׂנָה עֵר וְעֵנָה מֵאֹהֲלֵי יַעֲקֹב	"May God leave to <u>any man who has done this</u> no descendants dwelling in the tents of Jacob"

Test #3: Introducing an Unquantified Subset of a Known Group

Now I will treat a third usage pattern of interest that is quite different from the other two, in order to plumb the depths of the putative discourse function of *אִישׁ*. This pattern occurs when a biblical speaker refers to an unquantified subset of a known human group, while introducing that subgroup into the discourse as a distinct entity. For

example, in the book of Exodus, a narrator describes an attempt by Israelites to find manna in the wilderness as follows (Exod 16:27):²⁵

וַיְהִי בַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי יֵצְאוּ מִן־הָעָם לִלְקֹט

On the seventh day some of the people went out to gather.... (NRSV)

That is, out of a group that is identifiable to the audience, such as הָעָם, some number of its members are singled out. The size of that subgroup is left unspecified; what matters is simply that its members belong to the larger group.

In biblical texts, a subgroup is individuated in one of two basic ways. The main way is the partitive construction that we have just seen, in which the preposition מִן governs a label for the already-identifiable larger group. This streamlined device invokes the new subgroup only by implication.

An alternative way to introduce such a subset employs the plural noun אַנְשִׁים. It appears together with the partitive construction, as in the prophet Ezekiel's recounting of a visit paid to him (Ezek 14:1):²⁶

וַיְהִי | . . . בַּעֲשׂוֹר לַחֹדֶשׁ בָּאוּ אַנְשִׁים מִזִּקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

on the tenth day of the month, certain elders of Israel came (NRSV)

Here the bare noun phrase אַנְשִׁים refers directly to the newly identified subset.²⁷

Making a reference in this second manner is more verbose. Plausibly the noun's presence overtly codes a special signal, regarding its referent's importance for the audience's grasp of the depicted situation.

In order to test this idea, I compared 40 biblical instances that use the partitive construction only, with the 13 that combine the partitive construction with אַנְשִׁים. These two ways to introduce a subset are distributed widely: both are employed by multiple voices; and both kinds appear in each of five disparate books (Table 5).²⁸ I again conclude that the two variant constructions were alternative expressions employed by the same Hebrew speakers.

25 Alternatively, an introductory phrase can begin with the prefixed preposition בְּ (in), as in 2 Kgs 17:25; Jer 37:10. For simplicity, I write in terms of the prevailing way to indicate subgroup relationships, which is מִן (of, from).

26 This verse's syntactic and semantic structures are similar to those in the one just adduced: a temporal clause is followed by a *qatal* verb of motion, and then by its subject, which involves a partitive phrase. The presence of our noun is thus the most striking difference.

27 As is well known among linguists, a noun regularly *individuates* its referents, and its plural form *quantifies* them. In ancient Hebrew, a bare plural noun can do both.

28 For the full set of 53 cases, see Table 9 (above, n. 1). Additional instances of the partitive-only construction may well exist, but they would not materially affect the present study's conclusions.

Table 5: Introducing an unquantified subset of a group: comparison and distribution

Book	Locale	Coding	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS [additions in brackets]
Num	21:1	Zero	וַיִּלָּחֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּשָּׁב מִמֶּנּוּ שָׂבִי	he engaged Israel in battle and took <u>some</u> of them captive
Num	31:3	Overt	וַיִּחַלְצוּ מֵאֶתְכֶם אֲנָשִׁים לְצָבָא	"Let [<u>some</u>] men be picked out from among you for a campaign"
2 Kgs	25:12	Zero	וּמִדֹּלַת הָאָרֶץ הַשָּׂאִיר רַב־טַבָּחִים	<u>some</u> of the poorest in the land were left by the chief of the guards
1 Kgs	11:17	Overt	וַיִּבְרַח אֲדָד הוּא וְאֲנָשִׁים אֲדָמִיִּים מֵעֲבָדֵי אָבִיו אֹתוֹ	But Hadad, together with <u>some</u> Edomite men, servants of his father, escaped
Jer	39:10	Zero	וּמִן־הָעָם הַדָּלִים ... הַשָּׂאִיר נִבְזָרָאֲדָן	But <u>some</u> of the poorest people ... were left ... by Nebuzaradan
Jer	26:17	Overt	וַיָּקֻמוּ אֲנָשִׁים מִזִּקְנֵי הָאָרֶץ	<u>some</u> of the elders of the land arose
Neh	13:19	Zero	וּמִנְעָרֵי הָעִמָּדָתִי עַל־הַשְּׁעָרִים	I stationed <u>some</u> of my servants at the gates
Neh	13:25	Overt	וְאָרִיב עִמָּם וְאֶקְלָלֵם וְאֶכָּה מֵהֶם אֲנָשִׁים	I censured them, cursed them, [and] flogged [<u>certain</u> of] them
2 Chr	21:4	Zero	וַיַּהַרְג אֶת־כָּל־אֶחָיו בַּחֶרֶב וְגַם מִשָּׂרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל:	[He] put to the sword all his brothers, as well as <u>some</u> of the officers of Israel.
2 Chr	28:12	Overt	וַיָּקֻמוּ אֲנָשִׁים מִרְאשֵׁי בְנֵי־אֶפְרַיִם עַל־הַבָּאִים ...	<u>Some</u> of the chief men of the Ephraimites ... confronted those returning

My analysis found that the normal approach of using only a partitive prepositional phrase correlates consistently with a treatment of its referent as a given. In contrast, all of the cases with אֲנָשִׁים are necessary to the speaker's framing of a situation that is of interest. It appears that this noun prompts the audience to modify its situation model as the subgroup is introduced. That is, here too the noun's presence marks a participant as cognitively essential.

Discussion: Cognition and the Deployment of אִישׁ

To explain varied usages of אִישׁ that conventionally have been considered uninformative, this paper has offered a communicative account: the speaker's use of אִישׁ can function to signal to an audience that its referent is essential for grasping the depicted situation. At the same time, this is also a cognitive-linguistic account, in that it ex-

plains the usages in question in terms of basic aspects of human cognition.²⁹ One of these aspects has already been mentioned, namely the mind’s habitual analysis of reality in terms of participants within situations. Similarly germane is the aspect of general cognition called *construal*. The linguist Ronald Langacker emphasises this concept in his theory known as Cognitive Grammar. He defines construal straightforwardly as “our ability to conceive and portray the same situation in alternate ways” (Langacker 2015, 120; see also 1991, 315).

In the Hebrew Bible, a speaker’s construal of the depicted situation appears to determine whether **שֵׁנִי** is employed in a referring expression. Thus, **שֵׁנִי** is not used when that situation is already established and the participant in question is construed as a given. Rather, our noun is deployed only when the speaker is framing a new or dramatically altered situation. Consequently, **שֵׁנִי** has a discourse function: it marks a participant whose involvement defines the situation of interest.

Conclusion

Three independent, robust lines of evidence support the conclusion that wherever **שֵׁנִי** seems uninformative (superfluous) in a referring expression—and even in some cases where it makes a semantic contribution—it is alerting us to its referent’s situational import according to the speaker’s construal. This approach accounts for 129 instances of **שֵׁנִי** that are otherwise pointless or puzzling: the 9 adduced in Test #1, plus 120 similar cases cited in the online documentation.³⁰ The proposed understanding of **שֵׁנִי** is compelling: not only is it more comprehensive and parsimonious than any previous account, but also it yields a biblical text that is more coherent and informative—just as one would expect from a literary work.³¹

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Prof. Christo H. J. van der Merwe provided crucial encouragement to develop the basic insight behind this paper.

29 On this procedural commitment in cognitive linguistics, see, e.g., Evans 2019, 35, 37–38.

30 See [Tables 6, 7B, and 10](#) (above, note 1).

31 Deployment of **שֵׁנִי** to indicate that its referent is a situation-defining participant goes far beyond the differential coding explored in this paper. The signalling of essential participation is actually this noun’s prototypical and most frequent function. Furthermore, **שֵׁנִי** is almost always the human noun that is tapped to carry out this function in Ancient Hebrew (Stein 2020). Hence **שֵׁנִי** belongs in a class of its own: a “situational noun” (Stein 2021).

Abbreviations

- ESV = English Standard Version (2001)
- NJPS = New Jewish Publication Society translation, 2nd ed. (1999)
- NRSV = New Revised Standard Version (1989)
- RJPS = Revised Jewish Publication Society translation (gender-sensitive; in preparation for 2022)
- SB = Schocken Bible, trans. by Everett Fox (1995)

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Supplement to

David E. S. Stein

The Noun שֵׁנָה in Ancient Hebrew: A Marker of Essential Participation

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Die für uns wichtigsten Aspekte der Dinge sind durch ihre Einfachheit und Alltäglichkeit verborgen.¹

—Ludwig Wittgenstein

Tables 6–10

See [the pages following](#) the excursuses and bibliography.

Excursus 1: On Prior Scholarship on שֵׁנָה-headed Appositions

Lexicographers. J. G. Eichhorn, in revising Johann Simonis’ well-regarded 1756 dictionary (2nd ed., 1793), appears to have been the first lexicographer to mention שֵׁנָה-headed appositions. He cited representative instances, glossing all of them as if they had the same meaning as the appositive term alone. Eichhorn’s precedent has largely been followed ever since; see [Table 2](#) in the main paper for some citations.

In the Brown-Driver-Briggs English adaptation of Gesenius’ *Lexicon* (1906a, 36), the article on שֵׁנָה simply cites several instances under the rubric of “often prefixed to other nouns in apposition,” without further remark on the resulting meaning of that construction. However, the article on שֵׁנָה explicitly cites five instances of שֵׁנָה-headed appositions, glossing them as if שֵׁנָה is meaningless (1906b, 61).

Grammarians. See [Table 2](#) in the main paper.

Historical Linguists. W. E. Staples (1941) and Tyler Yoder (2015) have explained שֵׁנָה-headed appositions as a vestigial scribal practice, transferred from the cognate language of Akkadian (long a lingua franca in the ancient Near East). They point out that in Akkadian, a particular *determinative marker* was occasionally written before human occupational and gentilic terms as a classifier—to mark the following word as a human noun.²

The two authors observed a surface resemblance between the respective practices in the two languages, in two respects. First, the Akkadian determinative in question

¹ “The aspects of things that are most important for us are hidden because of their simplicity and familiarity” (Wittgenstein 1953, 50—Part I, No. 129; Anscombe’s translation).

² Staples explains the motivation for this supposed development: “Mesopotamian pictographs ... took on a multiple of syllabic values. When this happened, certain aids became necessary for the reader to give the correct value to the sign or signs” (1941, 139).

(the marker LÚ) can also be read as a word: *awīlu*, ‘human; free man’—equivalent to *amīlu* in Standard Babylonian—which is the cognate term to אִישׁ in Hebrew. Second, both the determinative marker (in Akkadian) and the head noun (in Hebrew) typically appear before *occupational* and *gentilic* terms; that is, they show up in similar situations.³

However, these correlations between the two languages do not imply causation. Furthermore, a crucial weakness of the determinative hypotheses is that a *motivation* is missing: why would an unspoken Akkadian practice have been adopted into biblical Hebrew texts, to be spoken aloud without any useful function?⁴

Excursus 2: The אִישׁ-headed Referring Expressions That Refer to Prostitutes

All nine of these referents are situation-defining participants. Four instances use אִישׁ to label specific participants (Josh 2:1; Judg 11:1; 16:1; 1 Kgs 3:16); one, to make definite deixis (Josh 6:22); and the remainder, to efficiently evoke a stereotyped situation for the sake of an instructive comparison (Jer 3:3, Ezek 16:30; 23:44; Prov 6:26). The fact that these instances variously involve non-specific, specific-unquantified, specific-quantified, and definite reference shows clearly that the presence of אִישׁ signals something else aside from either referential specificity or a newly introduced character. I will now discuss these instances in more detail (except for Judg 16:1, which is treated in the main paper), proceeding in Jewish canonical order.⁵

³ Yoder points to evidence that in the peripheral Akkadian usage in Canaanite diplomatic correspondence during the Amarna period, some determinatives were treated as words in their own right. (He adduces the evidence presented in Rainey [1996, 28–31], showing the syllabic recording of a usually logographic determinative. Yet neither Yoder nor Rainey account for why such markers were construed as words only *occasionally*.) If so, then the result would be similar to noun-noun apposition (and also to genitive constructs, in some cases). Yoder sees in this a possible precedent for the Hebrew appositions with our nouns. However, in at least some instances, the scribes were arguably replacing an existing apposition in their own language with a determinative-noun pair in Akkadian—e.g., “land of Egypt.” (See Rainey 1996.) Apparently it was the determinative that those scribes had found superfluous, not the noun that it became. Furthermore, if Eva von Dassow (2004) is correct, Canaanite scribes were already speaking with ’š-headed appositions in their native tongue, even before they altered standard Akkadian scribal practice.

⁴ The lexicographer Sukenik (1950) is one of the few scholars who has cited Staples, yet he then remarks tersely: אין השערה זו מתקבלת על הדעת ‘This hypothesis is implausible’. Meanwhile, as Yoder himself notes, similar appositions are also found in the (depicted) speech and literature of nearby nations. Hence if his hypothesis were correct, then a meaningless idiosyncrasy of a few scattered Canaanite scribes must have been adopted—for no apparent reason—internationally. This “bigger picture” implication argues against a Canaanite scribal origin.

⁵ In an additional instance (Lev 21:7), our noun is part of a common expression for describing a marriage relationship: לקח אשה. In such a construction, אִישׁ always indicates a womanly candidate for

1. Josh 2:1 discusses the spies dispatched by Joshua to Jericho:

וַיָּלְכוּ וַיָּבֹאוּ בֵּית-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה וּשְׁמָהּ רָחַב

They came to the household of a certain harlot by the name of Rahab

The speaker depicts the protagonists' arrival at a destination—a particular household—so the audience needs to be able to readily re-situate them there. Given that ancient Israelite (and presumably Canaanite) households were typically characterized by their head (i.e., the one who makes its resource allocations and commitments), this one is not surprisingly identified as belonging to a specific householder.⁶ Thus the depiction employs our noun to introduce its referent as essential to the situation that the audience is expected to grasp. The communication situation is similar to that in 2 Sam 17:18,

וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל-בֵּית-אִישׁ בְּבַחֲרִים

They came to the household of a certain man in Bahurim

In the present case, however, the speaker also needs to alert the audience to the unusual fact that a woman is heading this household, and therefore she is something of an outsider in her community; this state of affairs is explained by the appositive term, זֹנָה.

The communication task is distinct from that in Jer 5:7, which depicts a situation in typical (non-specific) terms, but in which a prostitute as householder is treated as a given (i.e., as an already established societal institution):

the marriage partnership. The discourse function of אִישׁ and אִשָּׁה in marriage idioms is similar to what is treated in the present paper—their referents likewise define the depicted situation—yet their realization is distinct enough that such cases are not included herein.

⁶ Arguably, according to standard pragmatic principles, the text's ancient audience would automatically enrich the meaning of אִשָּׁה here to mean 'householder'. For them, the social prominence of householders is a given part of everyday experience. For this reason, biblical storytellers—before focusing on the adventures of some member of a certain household—typically begin by orienting the audience to the identity of the householder: Judg 13:2; 17:1; 19:1; 1 Sam 1:1; 9:1; 17:12; 25:2; Ruth 1:1; cf. Gen 11:27; 37:2; Num 27:1; Judg 6:11; 11:1–2.) In contrast, dependent members of a household are conventionally situated in relation to their household's head (e.g., Saul in 1 Sam 9:2; David in 1 Sam 16:18; Ziba in 2 Sam 9:2; cf. this presupposition in questions about one's identity: Gen 24:23; 32:18; 1 Sam 17:55; 30:13; Ruth 2:5; and likewise in the answers to such questions: 1 Sam 30:13; 2 Sam 1:13). Consequently, this story's opening reference is so obviously to a householder *as such* that the noun אִשָּׁה (with its famously thin semantics) is enough to evoke that status. Indeed, a more specific referring expression, such as בַּעֲלַת בֵּית, would be construed here as pedantic. Because the audience's mind thinks in terms of situational gestalts, the speaker's use of the simpler noun אִשָּׁה suffices to evoke the householder—and thus it is preferred as more communicatively efficient.

וַיִּנְאַפוּ וּבֵית זֹנָה יִתְגַּדְּדוּ:

They committed adultery and trooped to a harlot's house.

2. Josh 6:22 depicts Joshua as he addresses the same spies while Jericho is being assailed:

בָּאוּ בֵּית-הָאִשָּׁה הַזֹּנָה

“Go enter the house of the harlot...”

Again, a destination of travel is at issue, which warrants the speaker's pointing to a specific household, headed by a specific individual of interest. Again, Rahab is consequential to the situation that the audience (in this case, the two spies) is expected to grasp.

3. Judg 11:1 introduces a new character:

וַיִּפְתָּח הַגִּלְעָדִי הָיָה גִבּוֹר חֵיל וְהוּא בֶן-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה וַיּוֹלֶד גִּלְעָד אֶת-יִפְתָּח.

Jephthah the Gileadite was a stalwart warrior; he was the son of a certain harlot. Gilead fathered Jephthah.

In this verse's second and third clauses, the speaker depicts a background situation that is germane for understanding the protagonist's present situation. That prior situation is a matter of his particular parentage. Each parent's identity matters.

The communicative situation is similar to that in other passages in which parentage is germane (Lev 24:10; 1 Kgs 7:14 [cf. 2 Chr 2:13]):

בֶּן-אִשָּׁה יִשְׂרָאֵלִית וְהוּא בֶן-אִישׁ מִצְרִי

...one whose mother was Israelite and whose father was Egyptian.

בֶּן-אִשָּׁה אֶלְמָנָה הוּא מִמִּטָּה נִפְתָּלִי וְאָבִיו אִישׁ-צִירִי

He was the son of a widow of the tribe of Naphtali, and his father had been a Tyrian....

In all three of these cases, the mother's identity is at least as consequential as that of the father—a fact that is conveyed by the use of *אִשָּׁה*, and not by its modifying term. (In English translations, the discourse role of our noun is subsumed within the assumed specificity of the parental relationship.) In the present case, the mother's consequential role is soon underscored by Jephthah's half-brothers, for they make her status a pretext for driving him away, as they address him (v. 2):

כִּי בֶן-אִשָּׁה אַחֲרַת אָתָּה

...for you are the son of another woman.

4. In 1 Kgs 3:16, the narrator introduces two new characters:

אֵז תְּבֹאנָה שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים זָנוֹת אֶל-הַמֶּלֶךְ וַתַּעֲמִדְנָה לְפָנָיו:

Then two prostitutes came to the king and stood before him. (NJPS)

The situation that is evoked centers around the classic role of a king as responsible for maintaining justice in the realm, such as by settling disputes (רִיב; e.g., 2 Sam 15:2–6). A dispute necessarily requires two disputants; they are the situation’s consequential participants by definition. In the Bible, disputants are prototypically designated as אִישׁ or אִשָּׁה ‘party’ (Stein 2020, §6.9.2–4, 7)—as here. Such styling enables the audience to grasp the situation schematically.

5, 6, and 7. In Jer 3:3 and Ezek 16:30—both couched in the second person—Yahweh as remonstrator is advancing a claim about the addressee, while seeking to alter the latter’s self-perception:⁷

וּמִצַּח אִשָּׁה זֹנָה הָיָה לָךְ מֵאַנְתָּ הַכָּלִים

... you had the [unfurrowed] brow of a typical harlot; you refused to be ashamed.

בַּעֲשׂוֹתֶיךָ אֶת-כָּל-אַלֶּה מַעֲשֵׂה אִשָּׁה-זֹנָה שְׁלֹטָת

...in your doing all of these things—[like] what an autonomous harlot typically does...

Ezek 23:44 is similar yet couched in the third person:⁸

וַיָּבֹא אֵלֶיהָ כְּבֹא אֶל-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה

He went to her as one typically goes to a harlot.

In all three cases, אִשָּׁה indicates the key participant in a depicted stereotypical situation that is invoked for the sake of comparison. The situation is presented schematically (for the audience’s rapid comprehension) by using our noun. (My rendering in terms of what is ‘typical’ is a rough attempt to indirectly convey the discourse function of our noun, which supports the schematic representation.)

8. Finally, in Prov 6:26, which is addressed to a young man, the discourse topic is the ultimately high cost of adultery, which at first sight might appear to be cost-free:

כִּי בַעַד-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה עַד-כֶּפֶר לָחֶם

וְאִשֶּׁת אִישׁ נֶפֶשׁ יִקְרָה תְּצוּד:

For a harlot typically costs just a loaf of bread;

but [with] a married woman [your] precious life is at risk [lit. ‘she hunts’].

⁷ In Jer 3:3, a stereotypical situation is invoked with argument focus, for contrast with the norm.

⁸ The speaker makes this comparison in the service of drawing a larger contrast between the relatively open manner in which men seeking extramarital sex approach a *harlot* and how they more surreptitiously approach a *married woman* (who is accountable to her husband—with adultery as a capital offense). See the 12th-century comment, ad loc., by Eliezer of Beaugency; and Moshe Greenberg 1997, 486–87.

The teacher invokes the alternative option of visiting a prostitute, for the sake of contrast. That scenario (situation) is depicted schematically in terms of its most consequential participant, who is marked with the label *אִישׁ*; it is claimed to be lower cost (less risky).

Excursus 3: Three Cases of Modification with a Relative Clause

The noun *אִישׁ* sometimes heads a referring expression that a relative clause that is introduced by the relative complementizer *אֲשֶׁר*. As is well known, such clauses can serve as substantives in their own right. This fact again raises the question of what is the need for *אִישׁ* in the constructions where it is modified by a relative clause. What does it contribute to the meaning of the utterance? The following three minimal pairs illustrate what *אִישׁ* contributes to meaning in such settings. The label *אִישׁ* appears to mark a participant whose presence defines the situation of interest.

Case #1. Leviticus 15:32–33

Both variants of the construction of interest appear in the same list of topics that summarizes the Priestly treatment of bodily discharges (Lev 15:32–33).⁹ The zero-coded version appears early in this list, in verse 32:

זֹאת תֹּוֹרַת הַזֵּב וְאֲשֶׁר תֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ שְׂכַבְתָּ-זֶרַע לְטִמְאָה-בָּהּ:

Such is the ritual concerning him who has a discharge:

concerning him who has an emission of semen and becomes unclean thereby,... (NJPS)

while the overtly coded version appears at the end of the list, in verse 33:

וְלִאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב עִם-טִמְאָה:

...and concerning a man who lies with an unclean woman. (NJPS)

The first relative clause (v. 32) serves as a referring expression on its own: ‘him who has an emission...’. The qualifying descriptions offered by both relative clauses (vv. 32 and 33) imply that each of their referents must necessarily be an adult male. For our purposes, the question is, if *אִישׁ* is not needed in the first referring expression, why is it needed in the second one? In the first case, the identified participants are treated as given. This construal befits the function of a summary statement: it necessarily mentions already-discourse-active participants.

The situation in the second case differs in that it involves not one participant but two. In order to frame this distinct situation succinctly, the speaker labels its first

⁹ Both of the identified construals of a given situation are common in the Priestly procedural texts. Because these two instances appear in a list rather than in a verbal clause, I do not include them in my tabulation.

participant as a situation-defining one, by using our noun **אִישׁ**. (By convention, the man is considered to initiate heterosexual relations.) This orients the audience to expect that a situation is being depicted. Then, together with the verb and preposition that indicate the relationship of interest (**וַיִּשְׁכַּב עִם**), an adjective that characterizes the second participant (**טְמֵאָה**) can suffice to make her presence clear.¹⁰

Case #2. *Leviticus 25:27 and 27:24*

Here I juxtapose two Priestly procedural instructions that refer to the buyer and to the seller of a hereditary landholding, respectively (Lev 25:27 and 27:24):¹¹

וְהָשִׁיב אֶת-הָעֶדָף לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר מָכַר-לוֹ

the difference shall be refunded to the party to whom it was sold... (CJPS)

יָשׁוּב הַשָּׂדֶה לְאִשְׁרָא קָנָהּ מֵאִתּוֹ

the land shall revert to the one from whom it was bought.... (CJPS)

In the first instance, our noun **אִישׁ** seems conspicuous, in that the speaker arguably could have omitted it, and the clause would still have been grammatical and informative. The key is that the two cases construe the sales transaction from different perspectives. In the first case, the instructions are cast in terms of what one party to the transaction should do with respect to the other party. Attention is on the situated *participants*.¹² The presence of **אִישׁ** can be explained as fulfilling a discourse function: it treats its referent as a participant who defines the situation of interest. In contrast, in the second case, the instructions are cast in terms of the land's transferral; the mentioned party is treated merely as a given. There, attention is on the situated *action*—rather than on its participants.

¹⁰ One could then wonder why **אִישׁ** was needed in v. 16 if its co-reference in v. 32 does not require it. In v. 16, it established a new case. For subsequent co-references, that case apparently remains discourse-active enough that the situation does not need to be constructed again from scratch. The intended referent can be treated as a given element.

¹¹ According to 25:1 and 27:1, the speaker in both cases is Yahweh. Although source-critical scholars have asserted that Leviticus 27 was a later appendix to the book, nonetheless the cited passage presupposes the treatment of the same topic in chapter 25, which it expands upon (Levine 1989, 192, 197). Continuity in the legal terminology is therefore expected. Consequently, it seems fair to treat the two passages' similar referring expressions as if they were variants available to a speaker of Ancient Hebrew.

¹² A participant-oriented construal of the situation is evident from how the case begins (v. 26): **וְאִישׁ כִּי לֹא יִהְיֶה-לוֹ גֹּאֵל** 'If any party lacks a redeemer...' (cf. Longacre 1994, 67).

Case #3. Deuteronomy 27:15 and 26

Both variants of the construction of interest appear in the same recitation of the types of offenders who warrant a communal curse in advance (Deut 27:14–26).¹³ The overtly coded version heads the list, in verse 15:

אָרוֹר הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשֶׂה פֶסֶל וּמַסֵּכָה ... וְשָׂם בְּסֵתֶר

Cursed be anyone who makes a sculptured or molten image...and sets it up in secret. (CJPS)

while the zero-coded version appears at the end of the list, in verse 26:

אָרוֹר אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִקְיָם אֶת־דְּבָרֵי הַתּוֹרָה־הַזֹּאת לַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתָם

Cursed be whoever will not uphold the terms of this Teaching and observe them. (CJPS)

The second relative clause (v. 26) serves as a referring expression on its own: ‘whoever will not...’. For our purposes, the question is, if *אִישׁ* is needed in the first referring expression, why is it not needed in the second one? It can be answered in terms of discourse function, as follows. The situation is already framed by the first instance. It sets up a basic situational triangle—consisting of the community, its power to curse, and the hypothetical wayward individual. The latter is then treated iteratively as a set of substitutes in the list that follows (referenced mostly via participles used substantively). This approach is known in Priestly regulation, as well.

Excursus 4: Three Case Studies to Account for the Presence/Absence of *אִישׁ*

Case #1. 2 Samuel 14:2; 20:16

In these two instances, a narrator famously employs the expression *אִשָּׁה חֲכָמָה*:

וַיִּשְׁלַח יוֹאָב תְּקוּעָה וַיִּקַּח מִשָּׁם אִשָּׁה חֲכָמָה

...so Joab sent to Tekoa and brought a clever woman from there. (NJPS)

וַתִּקְרָא אִשָּׁה חֲכָמָה מִזֵּה־עִיר

... when a clever woman shouted from the city... (NJPS)

Contra the cited translation, a number of scholars have suggested or claimed that this expression is something like a title or epithet. For example, it has been said to evoke a “culturally stereotyped character” (Camp 1981, 17) or a “particular role” in society (Frymer-Kensky 2002, 58) that now warrants capitalizing the rendering, as *Wise Woman* (Frymer-Kensky 1992, 129; 2002, 58–63). That is, the term expresses “a special status” (Stein 2006, 398) and “die Bezeichnung ruft etwas Bekanntes ab ... als

¹³ Both of the identified construals of a given situation are common in the Priestly procedural texts. Because these two instances appear in a list rather than in a verbal clause, I do not include them in my tabulation.

„Expertin“ vorgestellt” ‘it calls up something familiar ... [she is] presented as an “expert”’ (Schroer 2011, 397) in a “socially established role” (Häusl 2021, 238).

However, we should not confuse or conflate the two biblical women’s impressive roles in their respective narratives, and the self-possession that they managed to display, with the terminology that the narrator uses to introduce them. Indeed, the present paper’s results imply that as a matter of the passages’ plain sense, it would never have occurred to the text’s ancient audience to construe the phrase in question as a title or indicating a status, as I shall now explain.¹⁴

First of all, let us recall that the adjective by itself is regularly used on its own to refer to recognizably wise people (e.g., חָכָם in Prov 1:5; שְׂרוּתֵיהֶן חֲכָמוֹת in Judg 5:29). There is no need for the noun אִישׁ or אִשָּׁה in order to label sages as such. To assume so is to render that noun uninformative—which is the problem that generated this paper.

Second, if חָכָם אִישׁ or חֲכָמָה אִשָּׁה were the title of a recognized social role (like אִישׁ אֱלֹהִים), then we should expect that somewhere in the Bible a specific individual who is already active in the discourse would be labeled in that way. I.e., it would be used with definite deixis (like אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים). If that were the case, then it could plausibly be considered as a title. However, such usage is unattested. On the contrary, all 14 attested usages of חָכָם אִישׁ *contradict* the idea that it was ever used as a role title or status term. Consider, for example, the narrator’s observation in 2 Sam 13:3, וַיִּזְנֹב אִישׁ חָכָם מְאֹד, which cannot plausibly be construed as anything but ‘Jonadab was a very clever man’: אִישׁ is employed to signal a standard type of predication about the individual’s character. Similarly, when King David says to his son Solomon in 1 Kgs 2:9, כִּי אִישׁ חָכָם אַתָּה, he cannot plausibly be saying ‘for you are a Wise Man’ but rather ‘for you are an adroit man’—another characterizing predication. (Contrast 1 Kgs 17:24, כִּי אִישׁ אֱלֹהִים אַתָּה, ‘that you are an agent of God’.) Likewise in none of the other instances of חָכָם אִישׁ is the coherence or informativeness of the passage improved by assuming that this phrase refers to a recognized social role or status.

Consequently, construal of the expression חֲכָמָה אִשָּׁה properly relies upon the conventions of the language. When אִשָּׁה (like אִישׁ) is used to introduce a new participant into the discourse, its meaning contribution is not found on the informational level (except to indicate the referent’s social gender within the realm of human beings). Rather, this noun’s meaning lies in the realm of communication between the text’s composer and its audience; it is a matter of pragmatics. Specifically, as the present paper has shown, אִשָּׁה signals to the text’s audience that *the referent is a participant who is essential to the depicted situation*. The noun’s presence pointedly relates its

¹⁴ Thus I am now correcting my own misstatement of 15 years ago.

referent to the situation of interest—not to her community or to any other entity within the realm of the narrative.

In the cited verses, the expression *חַכְמָה אִשָּׁה* is *not* the title for an office or status of sage, because *אִשָּׁה* is *accomplishing something else*: it is being used for a conventional function. The expression in question is deployed in a manner that is utterly normal for introducing a new participant into the discourse throughout the Bible. Given that the narrator’s phrasing is consistent with this typical, mundane usage of *אִשָּׁה*, it would never even have occurred to the text’s ancient audience to construe the phrase as a title or status. It’s simply a psycholinguistic fact that the *conventional* interpretation of an utterance always takes cognitive priority over an *unconventional* one.

In conclusion, the construal of *חַכְמָה אִשָּׁה* in terms of a recognized role or status fails both of the tests of a plain-sense construal: it does not yield a more coherent and informative text in any passage, and it disregards the conventional use of *אִשָּׁה* in Ancient Hebrew. Thus although the idea that this expression indicates a communal role/status has been promoted by otherwise competent biblical scholars, *it does not hold water as the text’s plain sense*. The plain sense is: ‘a certain woman who was wise/clever/adroit’.

Case #2. Proverbs 22:7

In this case, four referents are mentioned—a pair apiece in two parallel situations:

עֲשִׂיר בָּרָשִׁים יִמְשׁוּל וְעֶבֶד לֹזֶה לְאִישׁ מְלֹזֶה:

The rich rule the poor, / And the borrower is a slave to the lender. (NJPS)

The question is: Why is *אִישׁ* mentioned for only the last one of the four participants, but not for the first three? This question is sharpened by Michael Fox’s observation about alliteration in his *Anchor Bible* commentary: “The proverb hisses with sibilants” (2009, 699). Arguably the composer of this aphorism could have used *אִישׁ* to add even more *sh* sounds—but did not take that opportunity. Why not?

In this verse’s first half, the two referents are treated as given—as social categories known from world knowledge. Apparently the intended construal is not only a generic one but also systemic (which supports the NJPS rendering in collective terms, as also in KJV, NRSV, and ESV—as opposed to Fox’s individual-oriented ‘The rich man rules over the poor’). The speaker’s focus is on the depicted action, namely, dominating. The depicted situation of societal asymmetry is treated as already established. For such a construal, in order to label the participants involved, an adjective (עֲשִׂיר) and a participle (רָשִׁים) suffice; the noun *אִישׁ* is not needed—indeed, its presence would alter the picture.

In contrast, the second half of the verse posits a related yet more specific situation

but with different construal: a recurring situation that is created one arrangement at a time, on an *ad hoc* basis. The noun **אִישׁ** helps the audience to grasp this depicted situation, even though its modifying participle **מְלִוֶה** can stand on its own as a substantive (cf. Isa 24:2).

Of the two parties, why is only the latter one coded with **אִישׁ**? Because the lender is construed as the dominant party; this is indeed the point of this proverb. As Fox notes (ibid.), “The borrower becomes a ‘slave’ insofar as he is subjecting himself to the lender’s goodwill, whims, and control. He may even end up as his actual slave, if forced to sell himself into debt slavery.” In the terms used in the present paper, it is the lender’s involvement that defines this situation. And this focus on the lender’s role is presumably intentional, in that the speaker seems to be pointing to the lender as a positive role model for the boy who, according to the conceit of the book, is being addressed. Indeed, many of the book’s proverbs seem to be constructed in a similar fashion—where **אִישׁ** is used to treat one particular party as definitive and as a positive or negative role model.

Furthermore, from a communications perspective, the speaker does not need to mark the term **לִוֶה** with our noun, in order for the situation to be readily grasped. In a reciprocally constituted two-party situation like this one, the speaker’s fully labeling only one party plus the relationship is sufficient to evoke the other party, as well.

Case #3. Ezekiel 45:20

In a study of *qôṭēl* participles, Benjamin Kedar-Kopfstein (1977, 170) analyzed a construction that combines **אִישׁ** with a qualifying *qôṭēl* into a single conceptual and syntactic unit.¹⁵ In the particular passage in question (Ezek 45:20), it denotes someone who accidentally introduces ritual impurity into the temple precincts:

מֵאִישׁ שֹׁגָה וּמִפְתִּי וּכְפָרָתָם אֶת־הַבַּיִת:

from an ’š-who-errs, or from an ignoramus; so you shall purge the temple.

Kedar-Kopfstein characterized this complex unit as *epitheton ornans* ‘a fancy moniker’. But why would the deity be resorting to fancy talk for labeling such an undesirable figure? In effect, the usage is unexplained, until we recognize that by definition, the participant in question *defines the situation*—by changing the temple’s status from pure to defiled. And as such, the use of **אִישׁ** would actually be expected (especially for the first in a list of other similar parties), according to my hypothesis.

¹⁵ This case involves a grammatical borderline construction: an **אִישׁ**-headed expression with a participle that is unattested in independent use as a substantive. For referential usages of **אִישׁ** modified by other participles (with various stems) whose status as a substantive is likewise unclear, see, e.g., Judg 18:11; 1 Sam 22:18; Jer 9:9; 10:23; 48:41; Ezek 16:32; 1 Chr 5:18.

Excursus 5: On Table 10 and Its Note Callers in Column 4

Like the cases in Tables 6, 7B, 8B, and 9B, these 89 additional cases of an *אִישׁ*-headed referring expression deploy a head noun that is conspicuously superfluous from a strictly grammatical perspective: if it were removed, the sentence would retain all of its grammatical parts, for a legitimate referring expression would remain, and the intended referent would still be clear. Arguably the gentilic, adjective, or substantival participle that currently serves as a modifier—or as the first modifier if there is more than one—could fulfill the referential function on its own.¹⁶ The audience would still correctly infer the referent's gender. And because such usages (including appositions) are found in 20 of the 24 books of the Hebrew Bible (i.e., all but Isaiah, Job, Song, Ruth, and Lamentations), they must be construed as a property of the language, rather than as the idiolect of particular speakers.

This approach to the data is merely a heuristic one. The fact that the speaker deemed *אִישׁ* to be necessary—despite its grammatical and referential superfluity—calls for explanation. Although this noun's presence is not well explained on the informational (semantic) level, it is readily accounted for on the discourse (pragmatic) level.

The column labeled *Notes* addresses the evidence for whether the modifier term can be used as a referring expression on its own, independently of *אִישׁ* as the head term.

Key to Note Sigla

- * The ability to serve as an independent substantive appears to be a property of gentilics as a linguistic category. This conclusion is based upon a wide range of gentilics. Given that it is acceptable in Ancient Hebrew to refer to an individual or a group via a gentilic as *הַעֲבָרִית* (Exod 1:19) or *הַמִּצְרִי* (Exod 2:12, 2:15) or *הַיִּשְׂרָאֵלִית* (Lev 24:10) or *הַמִּדְיָנִית* (Num 25:14) or *הַכְּנַעֲנִי* (Num 33:40) or *הַלִּי* (Judg 17:10–13) or *הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי* (as in 1 Sam 17:10–11, 16, 40–45, etc.), I cannot think of any reason why it would not be acceptable to employ a different (relevant) gentilic in reference to someone else, even if such use is not attested.
- ** This term is otherwise attested only in predicative (rather than referential) usage: Gen 20:3.
- *** This term is not attested in referential usage, but in the context of the full referring expression (the construct phrase *הָאִישׁ הַנֶּרְצָחָה*) it is arguably

¹⁶ Although usages of *אִישׁ* that elaborate upon or characterize a participant often resemble the cases under study (e.g., *כִּי אִישׁ חָכָם אַתָּה*, 'for you are a shrewd man', 1 Kgs 2:9), they are a distinct category because they serve a different discourse-level function.

capable of independently referring to the woman in question, due to its distinct gender marker.

**** See the discussion in [Excursus 4, case #2](#).

Numbered Notes

The following notes cite the modifier's *attested independent usage(s) as a referring expression* (i.e., without שֵׁנִי as a head term). Admittedly in the case of a gentilic, adjective, or participle, the fact that such usage is found elsewhere in the Hebrew Bible does not necessarily mean that all Ancient Hebrew speakers would have found its use in the present instance to be grammatical. That being said, the existence of such attestations does increase our confidence that such usage (without שֵׁנִי) would have been semantically acceptable—and therefore the inclusion of שֵׁנִי as a head term should be considered to be performing a discourse function. Furthermore, the listed usages provide a test for the general claim that in cases without שֵׁנִי, the speaker is treating the referent as a given.

- 1 Deut 21:15–16.
- 2 2 Sam 12:4; Jer 9:1; 14:8.
- 2A Ps 49:11.
- 3 Ps 94:8.
- 4 Exod 22:19; Zech 14:21; Eccles 9:2.
- 5 E.g., Exod 24:14; 2 Kgs 6:32.
- 6 E.g., Exod 29:33; Lev 22:10; Num 1:51; Isa 1:7.
- 7 Prov 5:3, 20.
- 8 E.g., Num 17:3; Isa 33:14; Ps 1:5.
- 9 E.g., Exod 7:11; Deut 16:19; Isa 29:14.
- 10 Jer 34:9.
- 11 Lev 24:10b.
- 12 Num 33:40.
- 13 Ezek 10:7.
- 14 Judg 17:10–13.
- 15 Num 25:17; 31:2.
- 16 Isa 29:21; Amos 5:10; Job 9:33; cf. Exod 2:14.
- 17 E.g., Lev 14:4, 7, 8, 11.
- 18 Cf. Ezek 33:32.
- 19 No Hofal instances. With Hiphil: Exod 21:19; Num 35:21, 24; Deut 25:11.
- 20 Isa 24:2.
- 21 Isa 57:3 (masc. sg.); Piel masc. pl. in generic ref.: Jer 9:1; 23:10; Mal 3:5.
- 22 Eccles 9:16.

- 23 Exod 2:12, 2:15.
- 24 Gen 42:9, 11, 14, 16, 31; Josh 6:23; 1Sam 26:4; 2Sam 15:10.
- 25 Jer 15:17; 30:19; 31:4.
- 26 2 Kgs 9:11.
- 27 E.g., Gen 41:39; Prov 1:5; 10:13.
- 28 E.g., Deut 14:21; 15:3; 23:21; 1 Kgs 8:41; Isa 2:6; Prov 2:16; 5:20; 7:5; 20:16.
- 29 2 Chr 14:7.
- 30 1 Sam 17:7; 1 Chr 12:25; 2 Chr 14:7.
- 31 1 Sam 14:11.
- 32 E.g., Lev 19:14; Deut 27:18; 28:29; Isa 42:18; 59:10.
- 33 E.g., Exod 22:24; Lev 19:10; Deut 15:11.
- 34 E.g., Prov 13:4; 15:19; 19:24.
- 35 2 Sam 12:2.
- 36 E.g., Isa 31:2; Hos 6:8; Ps 36:13; 53:5; 59:3.
- 37 Exod 38:8 (fem.).
- 38 E.g., Gen 18:23–25; Exod 23:7–8.
- 39 E.g., 2 Sam 12:1, 3.
- 40 2 Sam 6:20.
- 41 Gen 18:23; Exod 2:13; 23:7; Deut 25:1; 1Sam 24:14; Ps 109:6.
- 42 E.g., 1 Sam 1:13; Isa 24:20; 28:3.

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Table 6. *איש-Headed Appositions Used as Referring Expressions, Alphabetically by Modifier*

Context	Modifier	Locale	Speaker
דָּבַר הָאִישׁ אֲדֹנֵי הָאָרֶץ אֶתְּנוּ קִשּׁוֹת	אֲדֹנֵי אָרֶץ	Gen 42:30	Judah
וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֵינוּ הָאִישׁ אֲדֹנֵי הָאָרֶץ	אֲדֹנֵי אָרֶץ	Gen 42:33	Judah
אִישׁ־חֶכֶם נִשְׁפָּט אֶת־אִישׁ אֹוִל	אֹוִל	Prov 29:9	Anonymous
אָבֵל אִשָּׁה־אֶלְמָנָה אָנִי וַיָּמָת אִישִׁי:	אֶלְמָנָה	2 Sam 14:5	Joab's agent
בֶּן־אִשָּׁה אֶלְמָנָה הוּא מִמֶּטֶה נִפְתָּלִי	אֶלְמָנָה	1 Kgs 7:14	Narrator
הִנֵּה צִוִּיתִי שָׁם אִשָּׁה אֶלְמָנָה לְכַלְכֵּלָךְ:	אֶלְמָנָה	1 Kgs 17:9	Yhwh
וְהִנֵּה־שָׁם אִשָּׁה אֶלְמָנָה מְקַשֶּׁשֶׁת עֲצִים	אֶלְמָנָה	1 Kgs 17:10	Narrator
יֵצְאוּ אֲנָשִׁים בְּנִי־בְלִיעַל מִקֶּרְבְּךָ	בֶּן־בְּלִיעַל	Deut 13:14	Moses
וַעֲתָה תִּגְדּוּ אֶת־הָאֲנָשִׁים בְּנִי־בְלִיעַל אֲשֶׁר בַּגְּבֻעָה	בֶּן־בְּלִיעַל	Judg 20:13	Israel's agents
וְהוֹשִׁיבוּ שָׁנִים אֲנָשִׁים בְּנִי־בְלִיעַל נִגְדּוּ	בֶּן־בְּלִיעַל	1 Kgs 21:10	Jezebel
וַיָּבֹאוּ שְׁנֵי הָאֲנָשִׁים בְּנִי־בְלִיעַל וַיֵּשְׁבוּ נִגְדּוּ	בֶּן־בְּלִיעַל	1 Kgs 21:13	Narrator
יִשְׁאַת־עֲבָדֶיךָ חֲמִשִּׁים אֲנָשִׁים בְּנִי־חִיל	בֶּן־חִיל	2 Kgs 2:16	Prophetic disciples
וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֶל־הָאִישׁ בַּעַל הַבַּיִת הַזֶּה לֵאמֹר	בַּעַל הַבַּיִת	Judg 19:22	Narrator
וַיֵּצֵא אֵלֵיהֶם הָאִישׁ בַּעַל הַבַּיִת וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם	בַּעַל הַבַּיִת	Judg 19:23	Narrator
בְּקִשּׁוֹלִי אִשָּׁה בַּעֲלַת־אוֹב	בַּעֲלַת־אוֹב	1 Sam 28:7*	Saul
הִנֵּה אִשָּׁה בַּעֲלַת־אוֹב בָּעֵין דָּוִד:	בַּעֲלַת־אוֹב	1 Sam 28:7*	Saul's courtiers
חָלָה בֶן־הָאִשָּׁה בַּעֲלַת הַבַּיִת	בַּעֲלַת בַּיִת	1 Kgs 17:17	Narrator
בֶּן־אִישׁ גֵּר עַמְלָקִי אֲנָכִי:	גֵּר	2 Sam 1:13	Newsbearer
וַיִּסְפָּר שְׁלֹמֹה כָּל־הָאֲנָשִׁים הַגֵּרִים אֲשֶׁר בָּאָרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל	גֵּר	2 Chr 2:16	Chronicler
See Table 7B	זֹנָה	See Table 7B	See Table 7B
וּבַת אִישׁ כָּהֵן כִּי תַחַל לְזִנוֹת	כָּהֵן	Lev 21:9	Yhwh
לֵךְ מִנֶּגֶד לְאִישׁ כָּסִיל	כָּסִיל	Prov 14:7	Anonymous
הֵאֱלֹד וְקִרְאֵתִי לָךְ אִשָּׁה מִיִּנְקָת מֶן הָעֶבְרִית	מִיִּנְקָת	Exod 2:7	Sister (Miriam)
וַיִּשְׁלַח יְהוָה אִישׁ נָבִיא אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל	נָבִיא	Judg 6:8	Narrator
וַיִּקַּח־לוֹ אִשָּׁה פִּילְגֶשׁ מִבֵּית לָחֶם יְהוּדָה:	פִּילְגֶשׁ	Judg 19:1	Narrator
וְהִנֵּה הָאִשָּׁה פִּילְגֶשׁוֹ נִפְלְתָה פֶּתַח הַבַּיִת	פִּילְגֶשׁ	Judg 19:27	Narrator
וַיַּעֲזֹב הַמֶּלֶךְ אֶת עֶשֶׂר נָשִׁים פְּלִגְשִׁים לְשֹׁמֵר הַבַּיִת:	פִּילְגֶשׁ	2 Sam 15:16	Narrator
וַיִּקַּח הַמֶּלֶךְ אֶת עֶשְׂר־נָשִׁים פְּלִגְשִׁים אֲשֶׁר הֵנִיחַ לְשֹׁמֵר הַבַּיִת	פִּילְגֶשׁ	2 Sam 20:3	Narrator
אִישׁ צָר וְאוֹיֵב הָמֵן הָרַע הַזֶּה	צָר	Est 7:6	Esther
וַיִּבְדְּלוּ עֲזָרָא הַכָּהֵן אֲנָשִׁים רָאשֵׁי הָאֲבוֹת לְבֵית אֲבֹתָם	רָאשׁ אֲבוֹת	Ezra 10:16	Narrator
מִי שָׁמַיָּה לְאִישׁ שָׂר וְשִׁפְטָ עָלֵינוּ	שָׂר	Exod 2:14	Hebrew slave
וּשְׁנֵי אֲנָשִׁים שְׂרִי־גִדּוּדִים הָיוּ בֶן־שָׁאוּל	שָׂר	2 Sam 4:2	Narrator
*The head noun's unusual form is construed as a dialectal variant of the usual absolute form אִשָּׁה.			

Table 7A. Reference to Prostitutes via זונה Alone

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS	Speaker
Gen	34:31	הַזֹּנָה יַעֲשֶׂה אֶת־אֲחֻזָּתָנוּ:	“Should our sister be treated like a <u>whore</u> ?”	Dinah’s bros.
Gen	38:15	וַיֵּרָאָהּ יְהוּדָה וַיַּחֲשֹׁבֶהָ לְזֹנָה	When Judah saw her, he took her for a <u>harlot</u>	Narrator
Lev	21:14	אֲלֻמָּנָה וְגִרוּשָׁה וְחִלְלָה זֹנָה אֶת־אִלָּהּ לֹא יִקַּח	A widow, or a divorced woman, or one who is degraded by <u>harlotry</u> —such he may not marry.	Yhwh
Deut	23:19	לֹא־תָבִיא אֶתְנֵן זֹנָה וּמַחֲרִיר כָּלֵב בֵּית יְהוָה	You shall not bring the fee of a <u>whore</u> or the pay of a dog into the house of the LORD	Yhwh
1 Kgs	22:38	וַיִּלְקֻוּ הַכְּלָבִים אֶת־דָּמּוֹ וְהַזֹּנוֹת רָחְצוּ	Thus the dogs lapped up his blood and the <u>whores</u> bathed [in it]	Narrator
Isa	1:21	אֵיכָה הִיְתָה לְזֹנָה קָרְיָה נְאֻמָּנָה	Alas, she has become a <u>harlot</u> , / The faithful city	Isaiah
Isa	23:15	מִקֵּץ שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה יִהְיֶה לְצָר כְּשִׁירַת הַזֹּנָה:	After a lapse of seventy years, it shall go with Tyre as with the <u>harlot</u> in the ditty:	Isaiah
Jer	2:20	וַתַּחַת כָּל־עֵץ רֹעֵן אַתָּה צֹעָה זֹנָה:	On every high hill and under every verdant tree, / You recline as a <u>whore</u> .	Yhwh
Jer	5:7	וַיִּנְאַפּוּ וּבֵית זֹנָה יִתְגַּדְּדוּ	They committed adultery / And went trooping to the <u>harlot</u> ’s house.	Yhwh
Ezek	16:31	לֹא־הָיִית כַּזֹּנָה לְקַלֵּס אֶתְנֵן	Yet you were not like a <u>prostitute</u> , for you spurned fees	Yhwh
Ezek	16:33	לְכָל־זֹנוֹת יִתְנוּ־נִדָּה	Gifts are made to all <u>prostitutes</u>	Yhwh
Ezek	16:41	וְהִשְׁבַּתִּיךְ מִזֹּנָה וְגַם־אֶתְנֵן לֹא תִתְּנִי־עוֹד	thus I will put a stop to your <u>harlotry</u> , and you shall pay no more fees	Yhwh
Hos	4:14	כִּי־הֵם עַם־הַזֹּנוֹת יִפְרְדּוּ וְעַם־הַקִּדְשׁוֹת יִזְבְּחוּ	For they themselves turn aside with <u>whores</u> / And sacrifice with prostitutes	Yhwh
Joel	4:3	וַיִּתְּנוּ הַיֶּלֶד בַּזֹּנָה וְהַיֶּלְדָּה מָכְרוּ בֵּין וַיִּשְׁתּוּ	And they bartered a boy for a <u>whore</u> , / And sold a girl for wine, which they drank.	Yhwh
Mic	1:7	כִּי מֵאֲתָנֵן זֹנָה קִבְּצָה וְעַד־אֶתְנֵן זֹנָה יָשׁוּבוּ	For they were amassed from fees for <u>harlotry</u> , / And they shall become harlots’ fees again.	Micah
Mic	1:7	כִּי מֵאֲתָנֵן זֹנָה קִבְּצָה וְעַד־אֶתְנֵן זֹנָה יָשׁוּבוּ	For they were amassed from fees for harlotry, / And they shall become <u>harlots</u> ’ fees again.	Micah
Nah	3:4	מֵרַב זְנוּיֵי זֹנָה	Because of the countless harlotries of the <u>harlot</u>	Yhwh
Prov	7:10	וְהִנֵּה אִשָּׁה לִקְרֹאתוֹ שֵׁית זֹנָה וְנִצְרַת לֵב:	A woman comes toward him / Dressed like a <u>harlot</u> , with set purpose.	“Solomon”
Prov	23:27	כִּי־שׁוֹחָה עֲמֻקָּה זֹנָה	A <u>harlot</u> is a deep pit	“Solomon”
Prov	29:3	וְלֹעָה זֹנוֹת יֹאבֶד־הֶוֶן:	But he who keeps company with <u>harlots</u> will lose his wealth.	“Solomon”

Table 7B. Reference to Prostitutes via איש-headed Apposition

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	My Idiomatic Rendering, Highlighting the Role of אישה	Speaker
Josh	2:1	וַיָּבֹאוּ בֵּית-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה וּשְׁמָהּ רָחַב	They came the house of a certain harlot by the name of Rahab	Narrator
Josh	6:22	בָּאוּ בֵּית-הָאִשָּׁה הַזֹּנָה	Go to that harlot's house	Joshua
Judg	11:1	וַיִּפְתַּח הַגִּלְעָדִי הָיָה גִּבּוֹר חַיִּל וְהוּא בֶן-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה	Jephthah the Gileadite was a stalwart warrior; he was the son of a certain harlot	Narrator
Judg	16:1	וַיֵּרָא-שָׁם אִשָּׁה זֹנָה	There he saw a certain harlot	Narrator
1 Kgs	3:16	אִזְ תָּבֹאנָה שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים זֹנוֹת אֶל-הַמֶּלֶךְ	Thus two particular harlots came to the king	Narrator
Jer	3:3	וּמִצַּח אִשָּׁה זֹנָה הָיָה לָךְ	You had the forehead of a typical harlot	Yhwh
Ezek	16:30	בַּעֲשׂוֹתְךָ אֶת-כָּל-אֵלֶּה מַעֲשֵׂה אִשָּׁה-זֹנָה שְׁלָטַת:	Your doing all of these things [was like] what the autonomous harlot typically does	Yhwh
Ezek	23:44	וַיָּבֹא אֵלֶיהָ כְּבֹא אֶל-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה	He went to her as one typically goes to a harlot	Yhwh
Prov	6:26	כִּי בַעַד-אִשָּׁה זֹנָה עַד-כֶּכֶר לֶחֶם וְאִשָּׁת אִישׁ נִפֶּשׁ יִקְרָה תְּצוּד:	For a harlot typically costs just a loaf of bread; but a married woman hunts [your] precious life.	"Solomon"

Table 8A. Substantive אשר Clauses (without איש) in Verbal Complements

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS	Speaker
Gen	43:16	וַיֹּאמֶר לְאִשֶּׁר עַל-בֵּיתוֹ	he said to <u>his house steward</u>	Narrator
Gen	44:1	וַיֵּצֵא אֶת-אִשֶּׁר עַל-בֵּיתוֹ	Then he instructed <u>his house steward</u>	Narrator
Gen	44:4	וַיֹּסֶף אָמַר לְאִשֶּׁר עַל-בֵּיתוֹ	Joseph said to <u>his steward</u>	Narrator
Lev	5:24	לְאִשֶּׁר הוּא לוֹ יִתְּנֶנּוּ בַּיּוֹם אֲשֶׁמָּתוֹ	He shall pay it to <u>its owner</u> when he realizes his guilt.	Yhwh
Lev	27:24	a בְּשָׁנַת הַיּוֹבֵל יָשׁוּב הַשָּׂדֶה לְאִשֶּׁר קָנָהּ מֵאִתּוֹ	In the jubilee year the land shall revert to <u>him from whom it was bought</u>	Yhwh
Lev	27:24	b לְאִשֶּׁר-לוֹ אֲחֻזַּת הָאָרֶץ	<u>whose holding the land is</u>	Yhwh
Num	5:7	וַיִּתֵּן לְאִשֶּׁר אֲשֶׁם לוֹ	giving it to <u>him whom he has wronged</u>	Yhwh
1 Sam	30:27	לְאִשֶּׁר בְּבֵית-אֵל וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּרָמֹת-נֶגֶב וּלְאִשֶּׁר בֵּיתֵר	[He sent the spoil to the elders: those] in Bethel, Ramoth-negeb, and Jattir;	Narrator
1 Sam	30:28	וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּעָרֹעַר וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּשַׁפְמוֹת וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּאַשְׁתִּמֹּעַ	in Aroer, Siphmoth, and Eshtemoa;	Narrator
1 Sam	30:29	וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּרָכָל וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּעָרֵי הִירְחִמְאֵלִי וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּעָרֵי הַקִּינִי	in Racal, in the towns of the Jerahmeelites, and in the towns of the Kenites;	Narrator
1 Sam	30:30	וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּחֶרְמָה וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּבוֹר-עֲשָׁן וּלְאִשֶּׁר בַּעַתָּד	in Hormah, Bor-ashan, and Athach;	Narrator
1 Sam	30:31	וּלְאִשֶּׁר בְּחֶבְרוֹן	and to <u>those in Hebron</u>	Narrator
2 Kgs	10:22	וַיֹּאמֶר לְאִשֶּׁר עַל-הַמְּלָתָחָה	He said to <u>the man in charge of the wardrobe</u>	Narrator
Isa	31:6	שׁוּבוּ לְאִשֶּׁר הָעֲמִיקוּ סָרָה	Return ... to <u>Him to whom they have been so shamefully false</u>	Prophet
Isa	49:9	לֵאמֹר לְאִסּוּרִים צֵאוּ לְאִשֶּׁר בַּחֹשֶׁךְ הִגְלוּ	Saying to the prisoners, "Go free," / To <u>those who are in darkness</u> , "Show yourselves."	Prophet
Jer	27:5	אֲנִכִּי עָשִׂיתִי אֶת-הָאָרֶץ ... וַנִּתְּתִיהָ לְאִשֶּׁר יֵשֶׁר בְּעֵינָי	"It is I who made the earth ... and I give it to <u>whomever I deem proper</u> ."	Yhwh
Jer	50:20	כִּי אֶסְלַח לְאִשֶּׁר אֲשָׂאִיר	For I will pardon <u>those I allow to survive</u>	Yhwh
Amos	6:10	וַאֲמַר לְאִשֶּׁר בִּירְכָתִי הַבַּיִת	and he calls to <u>the one at the rear of the house</u>	Prophet
Mal	3:18	וְרֵאִיתֶם ... בֵּין עֶבֶד אֱלֹהִים לְאִשֶּׁר לֹא עָבָדוֹ	you shall ... see the difference ... between him who has served God and <u>him who has not served Him</u> .	Prophet
Job	12:6	לְאִשֶּׁר הֵבִיא אֱלֹהֵי בִידּוֹ	<u>Those whom God's hands have produced</u> .	Job
Eccl	9:2	כָּאִשֶּׁר לְכָל מְקָרָה אֶחָד ... וְלֹזֶבֶת וּלְאִשֶּׁר אֵינָנּוּ זֹבֵחַ	For the same fate is in store for all: ... for him who sacrifices, and for <u>him who does not</u>	Kohelet

Table 8B. איש in Verbal Complements, Modified by an אשר Clause

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS [with insertions for clarity in brackets]	Speaker
Gen	34:14	לֹא נוֹכַל ... לָתֵת אֶת־אֲחֹתֵנוּ לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ עֶרְלָה	"We cannot ... give our sister to a <u>man who is uncircumcised</u> ..."	Dinah's bros.
Gen	38:25	לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־אֵלֶּה לוֹ אֲנֹכִי הָרָה	"I am with child by the <u>man to whom these belong</u> ."	Tamar
Gen	43:19	וַיֵּגֶשׁוּ אֶל־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר עַל־בֵּית יוֹסֵף	So they went up to Joseph's house steward...	Narrator
Lev	25:27	וְהָשִׁיב אֶת־הָעֶדְף לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר מָכַר־לוֹ	[he shall] refund the difference to the <u>man to whom he sold it</u>	Yhwh
Num	9:13	וְהָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־הוּא טָהוֹר וּבִדְרֹךְ לֹא־הָיָה וְחָדַל לַעֲשׂוֹת הַפֶּסַח	But if a <u>man who is clean</u> and not on a journey refrains from offering the passover sacrifice...	Yhwh
Deut	25:9	כִּכָּה יַעֲשֶׂה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִבְנֶה אֶת־בֵּית אָחִיו	"Thus shall be done to the <u>man who will not build up his brother's house!</u> "	Moses
1 Sam	17:26	מִה־יַּעֲשֶׂה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִכֶּה אֶת־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הַזֶּה	"What will be done for the <u>man who kills that Philistine</u> ...?"	David
1 Sam	17:27	כֹּה יַעֲשֶׂה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִכּוּ	what would be done for the <u>man who killed him</u>	Narrator
1 Sam	25:11	וְנָתַתִּי לְאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר לֹא יָדַעְתִּי אִי מְזֶה הֵמָּה	"[Should I] give them to <u>men who come from I don't know where</u> ?"	Nabal
2 Sam	3:20	וַיַּעַשׂ דָּוִד לְאַבְנֵר וּלְאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־אִתּוֹ מִשְׁתֶּה	David made a feast for Abner and the <u>men with him</u> .	Narrator
2 Kgs	22:15	אָמְרוּ לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַח אֶתְכֶם אֵלַי	"Say to the <u>man who sent you to me</u> :..."	Huldah
Mal	2:12	יִכְרַת יְהוָה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשֶׂנָה עַר וְעָנָה מֵאֵהְלֵי יַעֲקֹב	"May the LORD leave to <u>him who does this</u> no descendants dwelling in the tents of Jacob..."	Prophet
Est	6:9	וְהִלְבִּישׁוּ אֶת־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר הִמְלִיךְ חֲפֶז בִּיקְרוֹ	"And let the <u>man whom the king desires to honor</u> be attired..."	Haman
Est	6:9	כִּכָּה יַעֲשֶׂה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר הִמְלִיךְ חֲפֶז בִּיקְרוֹ	"This is what is done for the <u>man whom the king desires to honor!</u> "	Haman
Est	6:11	כִּכָּה יַעֲשֶׂה לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר הִמְלִיךְ חֲפֶז בִּיקְרוֹ	"This is what is done for the <u>man whom the king desires to honor!</u> "	Haman
2 Chr	34:23	אָמְרוּ לְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַח אֶתְכֶם אֵלַי	"Say to the <u>man who sent you to Me</u> ,..."	Huldah

Textual notes about ancient witnesses:

- LXX does not contain a passage equivalent to 1 Sam 17:26–27 (and surrounding verses).

Table 9A. Introducing an Unquantified Subset of a Known Group: Zero-Coded

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS [with insertions for clarity in brackets]	Speaker
Exod	16:27	יֵצְאוּ מִן־הָעָם לְלֶקֶט וְלֹא מֵצֵאוּ:	<u>some</u> of the people went out ... to gather	Narrator
Exod	17:5	וְקַח אִתָּךְ מִזִּקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל	“take with you <u>some</u> of the elders of Israel...”	Yhwh
Exod	34:16	וְלִקַּחְתָּ מִבְּנֹתָיו לְבָנֶיךָ	“And when you take wives from among their daughters for your sons...”	Yhwh
Num	21:1	וַיִּלָּחֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּשָּׁב מִמֶּנּוּ שְׁבִי:	he engaged Israel in battle and took <u>some</u> of them captive	Narrator
Judg	20:31	וַיַּחֲלוּ לְהַכּוֹת מֵהָעָם חֲלָלִים כַּפֵּעַם בַּפֵּעַם	As before, they started out by striking <u>some</u> of the men dead	Narrator
2 Sam	11:17	וַיִּפֹּל מִן־הָעָם מֵעַבְדֵי דָוִד	and <u>some</u> of David’s officers among the troops fell	Narrator
2 Kgs	20:18	וּמִבְּנֵיךָ אֲשֶׁר יֵצְאוּ מִמֶּךָ ... יִקָּחוּ	“And <u>some</u> of your sons, your own issue, ... will be taken...”	Yhwh
2 Kgs	25:12	וּמִדֹּלֹת הָאָרֶץ הַשְּׂאִיר רַב־טַבָּחִים	<u>some</u> of the poorest in the land were left by the chief of the guards	Narrator
Isa	39:7	וּמִבְּנֵיךָ אֲשֶׁר יֵצְאוּ מִמֶּךָ ... יִקָּחוּ	“And some of your sons, your own issue, ... will be taken...”	Yhwh
Isa	66:21	וְגַם־מֵהֶם אֶקַּח לַכֹּהֲנִים לְלוֹיִם	“And from them likewise I will take <u>some</u> to be levitical priests...”	Yhwh
Jer	39:10	וּמִן־הָעָם הַדְּלִים ... הַשְּׂאִיר נְבוּזַרְאֲדָן	But <u>some</u> of the poorest people ... were left ... by Nebuzaradan	Narrator
Jer	52:16	וּמִדֹּלוֹת הָאָרֶץ הַשְּׂאִיר נְבוּזַרְאֲדָן	<u>some</u> of the poorest in the land—were left by Nebuzaradan	Narrator
Dan	11:35	וּמִן־הַמְּשֻׁכִּילִים יִכָּשְׁלוּ	<u>Some</u> of the knowledgeable will fall	Divine agent
Ezra	2:68	וּמִרְאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת ... הִתְנַדְּבוּ	<u>Some</u> of the chiefs of the clans ... gave a freewill offering	Ezra
Ezra	2:70	וַיָּשְׁבוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים ... וּמִן־הָעָם	The priests ... and <u>some</u> of the people... took up residence	Ezra
Ezra	7:7	וַיַּעֲלוּ מִבְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִן־הַכֹּהֲנִים ... אֶל־יְרוּשָׁלַם	<u>Some</u> of the Israelites [and] the priests ... set out for Jerusalem	Ezra
Neh	7:70	וּמִרְאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת נָתְנוּ לְאוֹצֵר הַמְּלָאכָה	<u>Some</u> of the heads of the clans donated to the work treasury	Nehemiah
Neh	7:72	וַיָּשְׁבוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים ... וּמִן־הָעָם ... בְּעָרֵיהֶם	The priests [and] <u>some</u> of the people... took up residence in their towns	Nehemiah
Neh	11:4	וּבִירוּשָׁלַם יָשְׁבוּ מִבְּנֵי יְהוּדָה וּמִבְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן	while in Jerusalem <u>some</u> of the Judahites and <u>some</u> of the Benjaminites lived	Nehemiah
Neh	11:25	מִבְּנֵי יְהוּדָה יָשְׁבוּ בְּקִרְיַת הָאָרְבַּע	<u>Some</u> of the Judahites lived in Kiriath-arba and its outlying hamlets	Nehemiah

Table 9A. Introducing an Unquantified Subset of a Known Group: Zero-Coded

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS [with insertions for clarity in brackets]	Speaker
Neh	11:36	וּמִן־הַלְוִיִּם מַחְלְקוֹת יְהוּדָה לְבִנְיָמִן	<u>Some</u> of the Judahite divisions of Levites were [shifted] to Benjamin.	Nehemiah
Neh	12:32–35	וַיֵּלֶךְ אַחֲרֵיהֶם הוֹשֵׁעִיָּה ... וּמִבְּנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים בַּחֲצָצְרוֹת	behind them were Hoshaiiah ... and <u>some</u> of the young priests, with trumpets	Nehemiah
Neh	13:19	וּמִנְעָרֵי הָעִמָּדָתִי עַל־הַשְּׁעָרִים	I stationed <u>some</u> of my servants at the gates	Nehemiah
1 Chr	6:51	וּמִמְשַׁפְּחוֹת בְּנֵי קָהָת וַיְהִי עָרֵי גְבוּלָם	<u>some</u> of the families of the sons of Kohath had cities of their territory	Chronicler
1 Chr	9:3	וּבִירוּשָׁלַם יָשְׁבוּ מִן־בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה וּמִן־בְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן	while <u>some</u> of the Judahites and <u>some</u> of the Benjaminites ... settled in Jerusalem	Chronicler
1 Chr	9:28	וּמֵהֶם עַל־כָּלִי הָעֲבוֹדָה	<u>Some</u> of them had charge of the service vessels	Chronicler
1 Chr	9:29	וּמֵהֶם מְמַנִּים עַל־הַכֵּלִים	<u>Some</u> of them were in charge of the vessels	Chronicler
1 Chr	9:30	וּמִן־בְּנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים רַקְחִי הַמֶּרְקַחַת לְבָשָׂמִים	<u>Some</u> of the priests blended the compound of spices.	Chronicler
1 Chr	9:32	וּמִן־בְּנֵי הַקָּהָתִי מִן־אַחֵיהֶם עַל־לֶחֶם הַמַּעֲרֶכֶת	<u>some</u> of their Kohathite kinsmen had charge of the rows of bread	Chronicler
1 Chr	12:17	וַיָּבֹאוּ מִן־בְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן וַיְהוּדָה עַד־לְמָצָד	<u>Some</u> of the Benjaminites and Judahites came to the stronghold	Chronicler
1 Chr	12:20	וּמִמְנַשֶּׁה נָפְלוּ עַל־דָּוִיד ... וְלֹא עֲזָרָם	<u>Some</u> Manassites went over to David's side ... but they were of no help to them	Chronicler
2 Chr	16:10	וַיִּרְצֶץ אָסָא מִן־הָעָם בָּעֵת הַהִיא	Asa inflicted cruelties on <u>some</u> of the people at that time.	Chronicler
2 Chr	19:8	הָעֹמִיד יְהוֹשָׁפָט מִן־הַלְוִיִּם וְהַכֹּהֲנִים וּמֵרָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל	Jehoshaphat ... appointed ... <u>some</u> Levites and priests and heads of the clans of Israelites	Chronicler
2 Chr	21:4	וַיַּהַרְגֵם אֶת־כָּל־אָחָיו בַּחֶרֶב וְגַם מְשָׁרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל:	[He] put to the sword all his brothers, as well as <u>some</u> of the officers of Israel.	Chronicler
2 Chr	32:21	וּמִצִּיּוֹנִי מָעִיז שָׁם הִפִּילֻהוּ בַּחֶרֶב:	and there <u>some</u> of his own offspring struck him down by the sword	Chronicler
2 Chr	34:13	וּמִהַלְוִיִּם סוֹפְרִים וְשֹׁטְרִים וְשׁוֹעָרִים:	<u>some</u> of the Levites were scribes and officials and gatekeepers.	Chronicler

Table 9B. Introducing an Unquantified Subset of a Known Group: Overtly Coded with אנשים

Book	Locale	Masoretic Text (<i>Qere</i>)	NJPS [with insertions for clarity in brackets]	Speaker
Num	31:3	הַחֲלֹצוּ מֵאַתְכֶּם אַנְשִׁים לְצָבָא	“Let [some] men be picked out from among you for a campaign...”	Moses
Deut	13:14	יֵצְאוּ אַנְשִׁים בְּנֵי־בְלִיעַל מִקִּרְבְּךָ וַיִּדְּחוּ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי עִירָם	<u>some scoundrels from among you</u> have gone and subverted the inhabitants of their town	Moses
Josh	2:2	הִנֵּה אַנְשִׁים בָּאוּ הַנָּה הַלַּיְלָה מִבְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַחֲפֹר אֶת־הָאָרֶץ:	“ <u>Some men</u> have come here tonight, <u>Israelites</u> , to spy out the country.”	King’s agents
1 Kgs	11:17	וַיִּבְרַח אֲדָד הוּא וְאַנְשִׁים אֲדָמִים מֵעֲבָדֵי אָבִיו אֹתוֹ	But Hadad, together with <u>some Edomite men</u> , [from among the] <u>servants of his father</u> , escaped	Narrator
Jer	26:17	וַיָּקֻמוּ אַנְשִׁים מִזִּקְנֵי הָאָרֶץ וַיֹּאמְרוּ	<u>some of the elders of the land</u> arose and said	Narrator
Jer	37:10	כִּי אִם־הִכִּיתֶם כָּל־חֵיל כַּשְׂדִּים ... וְנִשְׁאַרוּ בָם אַנְשִׁים מִדֹּקְרִים	Even if you defeated the whole army of the Chaldeans ..., and [among them] only [some] wounded men were left	Prophet
Ezek	14:1	וַיָּבֹאוּ אֵלַי אַנְשִׁים מִזִּקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל	<u>Certain elders of Israel</u> came to me	Ezekiel
Ezek	20:1	בָּאוּ אַנְשִׁים מִזִּקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לִדְרֹשׁ	<u>certain elders of Israel</u> came to inquire	Ezekiel
Neh	1:2	וַיָּבֹא חֲנָנִי אֶחָד מֵאֲחֵי הוּא וְאַנְשִׁים מִיְּהוּדָה	Hanani, one of my brothers, together with <u>some men of Judah</u> , arrived	Nehemiah
Neh	13:25	וְאַרְיֵב עִמָּם וְאַקְלָלָם וְאַכָּה מֵהֶם אַנְשִׁים	I censured them, cursed them, [and] flogged [some of] them	Nehemiah
2 Chr	28:12	וַיָּקֻמוּ אַנְשִׁים מִרְאשֵׁי בְנֵי־אֶפְרַיִם ... עַל־הַבָּאִים	<u>Some of the chief men of the Ephraimites</u> ... confronted those returning	Chronicler
2 Chr	30:11	אֲדָ־אַנְשִׁים מֵאַשֶׁר וּמִנַּשֶּׁשֶׁה וּמִזְבֻּלוֹן נִכְנְעוּ וַיָּבֹאוּ לִירוּשָׁלַם:	<u>Some of the people of Asher and Manasseh and Zebulun</u> , however, were contrite, and came to Jerusalem.	Chronicler

Textual notes about ancient witnesses:

- In Jer 37:10, LXX employs an indefinite article τινες ‘some’ (modifying “wounded soldiers”) rather than directly representing the Hebrew prepositional phrase and noun.

Table 10. Additional Conspicuous איש-Headed Referring Expressions, Alphabetically by Modifier

Context	Modifier	Locale	Substantive	Notes
לֵךְ אֶהְב־אִשָּׁה אֶהֱבֵת רַע וּמִנְאָפֶת	אֶהֱבֵת רַע	Hos 3:1	Qal Participle	1
וְדוֹד בֶּן־אִישׁ אֶפְרָתִי הָזֶה מִבֵּית לֶחֶם יְהוּדָה	אֶפְרָתִי	1 Sam 17:12	Gentilic	*
וַיֵּרָא אֶת־הָאִישׁ הָאֶרֶח בְּרֹחַב הָעִיר	אֶרֶח	Judg 19:17	Qal Participle	2
כִּי־יִמָּצֵא אִישׁ שָׁכַב עַם־אִשָּׁה בְּעַלְת־בָּעַל	בְּעַלְת־בָּעַל	Deut 22:22	Qal Participle	**
אִישׁ־בָּעַר לֹא יֵדַע	בָּעַר	Ps 92:7	Adjective	2A
וַנִּתְחַדֵּךְ בְּיַד אֲנָשִׁים בָּעָרִים חֲרָשֵׁי מִשְׁחִית:	בָּעַר	Ezek 21:36	Qal Participle	3
וּבָא נָעַר הַכֹּהֵן וְאָמַר לְאִישׁ הַזֶּבֶחַ	זֹבֵחַ	1 Sam 2:15	Qal Participle	4
וַיַּחֲלֹל בְּאֲנָשִׁים הַזִּקְנִים אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵי הַבַּיִת:	זִקֵּן	Ezek 9:6	Adjective	5
לְמַעַן אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִקְרָב אִישׁ זָר אֲשֶׁר לֹא מִזֶּרַע אֶהְרֹן הוּא	זָר	Num 17:5	Adjective	6
לְהַצִּילֶךָ מֵאִשָּׁה זָרָה	זָרָה	Prov 2:16	Adjective	7
לְשִׁמְרֶךָ מֵאִשָּׁה זָרָה	זָרָה	Prov 7:5	Adjective	7
קִמְתָּם תַּחַת אֲבֹתֵיכֶם תִּרְבּוּת אֲנָשִׁים חֲטָאִים	חֲטָא	Num 32:14	Adjective	8
הָבוּ לָכֶם אֲנָשִׁים חֲכָמִים וְנִבְנִים וַיִּדְעִים לְשִׁבְטֵיכֶם	חֲכָם	Deut 1:13	Adjective	9
וְאִלָּךְ אֶת־רֹאשֵׁי שְׁבֻטֵיכֶם אֲנָשִׁים חֲכָמִים וַיִּדְעִים	חֲכָם	Deut 1:15	Adjective	9
וְאִישׁ חֲכָם יִכְפָּרְנָה:	חֲכָם	Prov 16:14	Adjective	9
אִישׁ־חֲכָם נִשְׁפָּט אֶת־אִישׁ אָוִיל	חֲכָם	Prov 29:9	Adjective	9
וְעַתָּה שְׁלַחְתִּי אִישׁ־חֲכָם יוֹדֵעַ בִּינָה לְחֹרֶם אָבִי:	חֲכָם	2 Chr 2:12	Adjective	9
וַיִּקַּח מִשָּׁם אִשָּׁה חֲכָמָה	חֲכָמָה	2 Sam 14:2	Adjective	9
וַתִּקְרָא אִשָּׁה חֲכָמָה מִן־הָעִיר	חֲכָמָה	2 Sam 20:16	Adjective	9
לְעֵינֵי אֲנָשִׁים יְהוּדִים:	יְהוּדִי	Jer 43:9	Gentilic	10
וַהֲחִיָּקוּ בִּכְנֹף אִישׁ יְהוּדִי לֵאמֹר	יְהוּדִי	Zech 8:23	Gentilic	10
אִישׁ יְהוּדִי הָיָה בְּשׁוֹשֵׁן הַבִּירָה	יְהוּדִי	Esth 2:5	Gentilic	10
וַיַּעַז בֶּן־אִשָּׁה יִשְׂרָאֵלִית	יִשְׂרָאֵלִית	Lev 24:10	Gentilic	11
וַיִּקַּב בֶּן־הָאִשָּׁה הַיִּשְׂרָאֵלִית אֶת־הַשֵּׁם	יִשְׂרָאֵלִית	Lev 24:11	Gentilic	11
וַיִּרְא־שָׁם יְהוּדָה בֶּת־אִישׁ כְּנַעֲנִי וּשְׁמוֹ שׁוּעַ	כְּנַעֲנִי	Gen 38:2	Gentilic	12
וַיִּקְרָא אֶל־הָאִישׁ הַלְבָּשׁ הַבָּדִים אֲשֶׁר קָסַת הַסָּפֵר בְּמִתְנָיו	לְבוּשׁ בָּדִים	Ezek 9:3	Adjective	13
וְהִנֵּה הָאִישׁ לְבָשׁ הַבָּדִים אֲשֶׁר הִקְסֵת בְּמִתְנָיו מִשִּׁיב דָּבָר	לְבוּשׁ בָּדִים	Ezek 9:11	Adjective	13
וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־הָאִישׁ לְבָשׁ הַבָּדִים	לְבוּשׁ בָּדִים	Ezek 10:2	Adjective	13
וַיְהִי בְּצֹאתוֹ אֶת־הָאִישׁ לְבַש־הַבָּדִים	לְבוּשׁ בָּדִים	Ezek 10:6	Adjective	13
וַיֹּאמֶר לְאִישׁ לְבוּשׁ הַבָּדִים	לְבוּשׁ בָּדִים	Dan 12:6	Adjective	13
וְאִשְׁמָע אֶת־הָאִישׁ לְבוּשׁ הַבָּדִים	לְבוּשׁ בָּדִים	Dan 12:7	Adjective	13
וַיְהִי אִישׁ לֹזִי גָר בִּירְכַתִּי הֶרֶא־פְּרִים	לֹזִי	Judg 19:1	Gentilic	14
וַיַּעַן הָאִישׁ הַלֹּזִי אִישׁ הָאִשָּׁה הַנִּרְצָחָה וַיֹּאמֶר	לֹזִי	Judg 20:4	Gentilic	14
וַיַּעֲבְרוּ אֲנָשִׁים מַדִּיָּנִים סָחָרִים	מַדִּיָּנִי	Gen 37:28	Gentilic	15
וְלֹא־תִהְיֶה לָהֶם לְאִישׁ מוֹכִיחַ	מוֹכִיחַ	Ezek 3:26	Hiph Participle	16
וְהַעֲמִיד הַכֹּהֵן הַמְּטַהֵר אֶת הָאִישׁ הַמְּטַהֵר וְאַתֶּם	מְטַהֵר	Lev 14:11	Hitp. Participle	17
רְאוּ־נָא לִי אִישׁ מִיִּטִּיב לְנִגֹּן	מִיִּטִּיב לְנִגֹּן	1 Sam 16:17	Hiph Participle	18
וְשֵׁם הָאִשָּׁה הַמִּכָּה הַמַּדִּינִית כְּזָבִי בַת־צֹר	מָכָה	Num 25:15	Hofal Participle	19

Table 10. Additional Conspicuous איש-Headed Referring Expressions, Alphabetically by Modifier

Context	Modifier	Locale	Substantive	Notes
וְעָבַד לַזֶּה לְאִישׁ מְלוֹה	מְלוֹה	Prov 22:7	Hiph Participle	20
הָאִשָּׁה הַמִּנְאָפֶת	מִנְאָפֶת	Ezek 16:32	Piel Participle	21
בֵּן דֶּרֶךְ אִשָּׁה מִנְאָפֶת	מִנְאָפֶת	Prov 30:20	Piel Participle	21
וּמִצָּא בָּהּ אִישׁ מִסְכֵּן חָכָם	מִסְכֵּן	Eccles 9:15	Adjective	22
וְאָדָם לֹא זָכַר אֶת־הָאִישׁ הַמִּסְכֵּן הַהוּא	מִסְכֵּן	Eccles 9:15	Adjective	22
פּוֹטִיפַר סָרִיס פְּרָעָה שֶׁר הִטְבַּחִים אִישׁ מִצְרִי	מִצְרִי	Gen 39:1	Gentilic	23
וַיֵּרָא אִישׁ מִצְרִי מִכָּה אִישׁ־עִבְרִי מֵאֲחִיו:	מִצְרִי	Exod 2:11	Gentilic	23
אִישׁ מִצְרִי הִצִּילָנוּ מִיַּד הָרָעִים	מִצְרִי	Exod 2:19	Gentilic	23
וְהוּא בֶן־אִישׁ מִצְרִי	מִצְרִי	Lev 24:10	Gentilic	23
וַיִּמָּצֵאוּ אִישׁ־מִצְרִי בַשָּׂדֶה	מִצְרִי	1 Sam 30:11	Gentilic	23
וְהוּא־הִכָּה אֶת־אִישׁ מִצְרִי	מִצְרִי	2 Sam 23:21	Gentilic	23
וְהוּא־הִכָּה אֶת־הָאִישׁ הַמִּצְרִי	מִצְרִי	1 Chr 11:23	Gentilic	23
כִּי לֹא כְנָשִׁים הַמִּצְרִית הָעִבְרִית	מִצְרִיָּה	Exod 1:19	Gentilic	23
וַיִּשְׁלַח יְהוֹשֻׁעַ ... שְׁנַיִם־אֲנָשִׁים מִרְגָּלִים חָרָשׁ	מִרְגָּל	Josh 2:1	Piel Participle	24
וַתַּעֲנִינָה הַנָּשִׁים הַמְשַׁחֲקוֹת	מְשַׁחֲקָה	1 Sam 18:7	Piel Participle	25
לְהַיֹּזֵת פְּקָדִים בֵּית יְהוָה לְכָל־אִישׁ מְשַׁגֵּעַ וּמִתְנַבֵּא	מְשַׁגֵּעַ	Jer 29:26	Pual Participle	26
וַעֲתָה יֵרָא פְרָעָה אִישׁ נָבוֹן וְחָכָם	נָבוֹן	Gen 41:33	Niph. Participle	27
לֹא תֹכַל לָתֵת עָלֶיךָ אִישׁ נָכְרִי אֲשֶׁר לֹא־אֲחִיךָ הוּא:	נָכְרִי	Deut 17:15	Adjective	28
וְלֹא־יִשְׁלִיטֶנּוּ הָאֱלֹהִים לְאָכַל מִמֶּנּוּ כִּי אִישׁ נָכְרִי יֹאכְלֶנּוּ	נָכְרִי	Eccles 6:2	Adjective	28
וַהֲבָדְלוּ מַעֲמֵי הָאָרֶץ וּמִן־הַנָּשִׁים הַנִּכְרִיּוֹת:	נִכְרִיָּה	Ezra 10:11	Adjective	28
גַּם־אוֹתוֹ הִחֲטִיאוּ הַנָּשִׁים הַנִּכְרִיּוֹת:	נִכְרִיָּה	Neh 13:26	Adjective	28
וַיַּעַן הָאִישׁ הַלֵּוִי אִישׁ הָאִשָּׁה הַנִּרְצָחָה וַיֹּאמֶר	נִרְצָחָה	Judg 20:4	Niph. Participle	***
מִן־בְּנֵי־חֵיל אֲנָשִׁים נִשְׂאֵי מִגֵּן וְחֶרֶב וְדֹרְכֵי קֶשֶׁת וּלְמוֹדֵי מִלְחָמָה	נִשְׂאֵי מִגֵּן	1 Chr 5:18	Qal Participle	29
וְהָאִישׁ נִשְׂאָה הַצָּנָה לְפָנָיו:	נִשְׂאָה צָנָה	1 Sam 17:41	Qal Participle	30
רְאוּ הֵבִיא לָנוּ אִישׁ עִבְרִי לְצַחֵק בָּנוּ	עִבְרִי	Gen 39:14	Gentilic	*
וַיֵּרָא אִישׁ מִצְרִי מִכָּה אִישׁ־עִבְרִי מֵאֲחִיו:	עִבְרִי	Exod 2:11	Gentilic	*
וְהִנֵּה שְׁנֵי־אֲנָשִׁים עִבְרִים נָצִים	עִבְרִי	Exod 2:13	Gentilic	31
וַיֵּט עַד־אִישׁ עַדְלָמִי וְשִׁמוֹ חִירָה:	עַדְלָמִי	Gen 38:1	Gentilic	*
כָּל־אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ מוֹם לֹא יִקְרַב אִישׁ עוֹר אֹז פֶּסֶחַ	עוֹר	Lev 21:18	Adjective	32
נָעַר מִצְרִי אֲנֹכִי עָבַד לְאִישׁ עַמְלִקִּי	עַמְלִקִּי	1 Sam 30:13	Gentilic	*
וַיִּרְדֹּף אִישׁ־עַנִּי וְאֲבִיוֹן	עַנִּי	Ps 109:16	Adjective	33
עַל־שִׂדָּה אִישׁ־עַצֵּל עֲבָרְתִּי	עַצֵּל	Prov 24:30	Adjective	34
וַיָּבֹא הַלֵּךְ לְאִישׁ הָעָשִׁיר	עָשִׁיר	2 Sam 12:4	Adjective	35
חָכָם בְּעֵינָיו אִישׁ עָשִׁיר	עָשִׁיר	Prov 28:11	Adjective	35
הַתְּעוֹלָל עֲלָלוֹת בָּרַשַׁע אֶת־אִישִׁים פְּעִל־אֶן	פְּעִל־אֶן	Ps 141:4	Qal Participle	36
אֲשֶׁר חָצָה מִשָּׁה מִן־הָאֲנָשִׁים הַצַּבָּאִים:	צַבָּא	Num 31:42	Qal Participle	37
כִּי־אֲנָשִׁים רָשָׁעִים הָרְגוּ אֶת־אִישׁ־צָדִיק בְּבֵיתוֹ	צָדִיק	2 Sam 4:11	Adjective	38
וְאֲנָשִׁים צָדִיקִם הָמָּה יִשְׁפְּטוּ אוֹתָהֶם	צָדִיק	Ezek 23:45	Adjective	38

Table 10. Additional Conspicuous איש-Headed Referring Expressions, Alphabetically by Modifier

Context	Modifier	Locale	Substantive	Notes
וַאֲבִיו אִישׁ-צָרִי חָרַשׁ נְחֹשֶׁת׃	צָרִי	1 Kgs 7:14	Gentilic	*
וַאֲבִיו אִישׁ-צָרִי יוֹדֵעַ לַעֲשׂוֹת בְּזָהָב וּבַכֶּסֶף׃	צָרִי	2 Chr 2:13	Gentilic	*
וַיִּקַּח אֶת-כַּבֶּשֶׁת הָאִישׁ הָרֹאשׁ׃	רֹאשׁ	2 Sam 12:4	Qal Participle	39
וַיִּשְׁכַּר בָּהֶם אַבִּימֶלֶךְ אַנְשִׁים רִיקִים וּפְחִזִּים׃	רִיק	Judg 9:4	Adjective	40
וַיִּתְּלֶקְטוּ אֶל-יִפְתָּח אַנְשִׁים רִיקִים׃	רִיק	Judg 11:3	Adjective	40
וַיִּקְבְּצוּ עָלָיו אַנְשִׁים רִיקִים בְּנֵי בְלִיעֵל׃	רִיק	2 Chr 13:7	Adjective	40
סֹוּרוֹ נָא מֵעַל אֶהְיֶה הָאֲנָשִׁים הַרְשָׁעִים הָאֵלֶּה׃	רְשָׁע	Num 16:26	Adjective	41
אֲףִי כִי-אֲנָשִׁים רְשָׁעִים הָרְגוּ אֶת-אִישׁ-צִדִּיק בְּבֵיתוֹ׃	רְשָׁע	2 Sam 4:11	Adjective	41
הֵעִז אִישׁ רְשָׁע בְּפָנָיו׃	רְשָׁע	Prov 21:29	Adjective	41
מֵאִישׁ שֹׁגָה וּמִפֶּתִי וּכְפָרְתָם אֶת-הַבַּיִת׃	שֹׁגָה	Ezek 45:20	Qal Participle	****
הָיִיתִי כְּאִישׁ שָׂכֹוֹר וּכְגֶבֶר עֲבָרוּ יַיִן׃	שָׂכֹוֹר	Jer 23:9	Adjective	42
וַתֹּאמֶר הָאִשָּׁה הַתְּקֹעִית אֶל-הַמֶּלֶךְ׃	תְּקֹעִית	2 Sam 14:4	Gentilic	*
וַתֹּאמֶר הָאִשָּׁה הַתְּקֹעִית אֶל-הַמֶּלֶךְ׃	תְּקֹעִית	2 Sam 14:9	Gentilic	*
For an explanation of the Notes, see Excursus 5 .				